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Methods, apparatus, systems and procedures for distance dependent random access channel (RACH) preamble selection in non-terrestrial networks (NTNs)

Abstract

Method, apparatus and systems are disclosed. In one representative embodiment, a method may be implemented by a wireless transmit/receive unit (WTRU) for communication via a network access point (NAP). The method may include the WTRU receiving from the NAP a set of preambles and corresponding propagation delay related thresholds and determining propagation delay related information associated with a distance between the WTRU and the NAP or a location in a coverage of the NAP. The method may further include selecting a subset of preambles from the set of preambles based on the determined propagation delay related information, randomly selecting a preamble from the selected subset of preambles, and sending the randomly selected preamble to the NAP.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/289,143, filed Apr. 27, 2021, which is a 371 U.S. National Stage Application, PCT Application No. PCT/US2019/057390, filed Oct. 22, 2019, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/752,453, filed Oct. 30, 2018, the contents of each of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

FIELD

(1) Embodiments disclosed herein generally relate to wireless communications and, for example to methods, apparatus and systems for distance dependent RACH preamble selection in NTNs.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) A more detailed understanding may be had from the detailed description below, given by way of example in conjunction with drawings appended hereto. Figures in the description, are examples. As such, the Figures and the detailed description are not to be considered limiting, and other equally effective examples are possible and likely. Furthermore, like reference numerals in the figures indicate like elements, and wherein:

- (2) FIG. 1A is a system diagram illustrating an example communications system in which one or more disclosed embodiments may be implemented;
- (3) FIG. 1B is a system diagram illustrating an example wireless transmit/receive unit (WTRU) that may be used within the communications system illustrated in FIG. 1A according to an embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 1C is a system diagram illustrating an example radio access network (RAN) and an example core network (CN) that may be used within the communications system illustrated in FIG. 1A according to an embodiment;
- (5) FIG. 1D is a system diagram illustrating a further example RAN and a further example CN that may be used within the communications system illustrated in FIG. 1A according to an embodiment;
- (6) FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating a representative Radio Resource Control (RRC) connection establishment procedure;
- (7) FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a variance in propagation delay inside a spot-beam;
- (8) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating a representative timing advance procedure;
- (9) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a position estimation with respect to a nadir and/or propagation delay differences in a NTN;
- (10) FIG. 6 is an overall flowchart illustrating a representative procedure for selection of distance dependent RACH preambles in a NTN;
- (11) FIG. 7 is flowchart illustrating a representative procedure to perform a RACH procedure;
- (12) FIG. 8 is flowchart illustrating another representative procedure for selection of RACH preambles based on propagation delay related parameters/information; and
- (13) FIG. 9 is flowchart illustrating another representative procedure using a Random Access-Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) as a function of, including or derived from propagation delay related parameter/information.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Example Networks for Implementation of the Embodiments

(14) As previously noted, embodiments may be implemented in a WTRU, a robotic vehicle, car, IoT gear, any device that moves, or other communication device, which, in turn, may be used in a communication network. The following section provides a description of some exemplary WTRUs and/or other communication devices and networks in which they may be incorporated.

(15) FIG. 1A is a diagram illustrating an example communications system **100** in which one or more disclosed embodiments may be implemented. The communications system **100** may be a multiple access system that provides content, such as voice, data, video, messaging, broadcast, etc., to multiple wireless users. The communications system **100** may enable multiple wireless users to access such content through the sharing of system resources, including wireless bandwidth. For example, the communications systems **100** may employ one or more channel access methods, such as code division multiple access (CDMA), time division multiple access (TDMA), frequency division multiple access (FDMA), orthogonal FDMA (OFDMA), single-carrier FDMA (SC-FDMA), zero-tail unique-word DFT-Spread OFDM (ZT UW DTS-s OFDM), unique word OFDM (UW-OFDM), resource block-filtered OFDM, filter bank multicarrier (FBMC), and the like.

(16) As shown in FIG. 1A, the communications system **100** may include wireless transmit/receive units (WTRUs) **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d**, a RAN **104/113**, a CN **106/115**, a public switched

telephone network (PSTN) **108**, the Internet **110**, and other networks **112**, though it will be appreciated that the disclosed embodiments contemplate any number of WTRUs, base stations, networks, and/or network elements. Each of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** may be any type of device configured to operate and/or communicate in a wireless environment. By way of example, the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d**, any of which may be referred to as a “station” and/or a “STA”, may be configured to transmit and/or receive wireless signals and may include a user equipment (UE), a mobile station, a fixed or mobile subscriber unit, a subscription-based unit, a pager, a cellular telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a smartphone, a laptop, a netbook, a personal computer, a wireless sensor, a hotspot or Mi-Fi device, an Internet of Things (IOT) device, a watch or other wearable, a head-mounted display (HMD), a vehicle, a drone, a medical device and applications (e.g., remote surgery), an industrial device and applications (e.g., a robot and/or other wireless devices operating in an industrial and/or an automated processing chain contexts), a consumer electronics device, a device operating on commercial and/or industrial wireless networks, and the like. Any of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** and **102d** may be interchangeably referred to as a UE.

(17) The communications systems **100** may also include a base station **114a** and/or a base station **114b**. Each of the base stations **114a**, **114b** may be any type of device configured to wirelessly interface with at least one of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** to facilitate access to one or more communication networks, such as the CN **106/115**, the Internet **110**, and/or the other networks **112**. By way of example, the base stations **114a**, **114b** may be a base transceiver station (BTS), a Node-B, an eNode B (eNB), a Home Node B (HNB), a Home eNode B (HeNB), a gNB, a NR Node B, a site controller, an access point (AP), a wireless router, and the like. While the base stations **114a**, **114b** are each depicted as a single element, it will be appreciated that the base stations **114a**, **114b** may include any number of interconnected base stations and/or network elements.

(18) The base station **114a** may be part of the RAN **104/113**, which may also include other base stations and/or network elements (not shown), such as a base station controller (BSC), a radio network controller (RNC), relay nodes, etc. The base station **114a** and/or the base station **114b** may be configured to transmit and/or receive wireless signals on one or more carrier frequencies, which may be referred to as a cell (not shown). These frequencies may be in licensed spectrum, unlicensed spectrum, or a combination of licensed and unlicensed spectrum. A cell may provide coverage for a wireless service to a specific geographical area that may be relatively fixed or that may change over time. The cell may further be divided into cell sectors. For example, the cell associated with the base station **114a** may be divided into three sectors. Thus, in one embodiment, the base station **114a** may include three transceivers, i.e., one for each sector of the cell. In an embodiment, the base station **114a** may employ multiple-input multiple output (MIMO) technology and may utilize multiple transceivers for each sector of the cell. For example, beamforming may be used to transmit and/or receive signals in desired spatial directions.

(19) The base stations **114a**, **114b** may communicate with one or more of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** over an air interface **116**, which may be any suitable wireless communication link (e.g., radio frequency (RF), microwave, centimeter wave, micrometer wave, infrared (IR), ultraviolet (UV), visible light, etc.). The air interface **116** may be established using any suitable radio access technology (RAT).

(20) More specifically, as noted above, the communications system **100** may be a multiple access system and may employ one or more channel access schemes, such as CDMA, TDMA, FDMA, OFDMA, SC-FDMA, and the like. For example, the base station **114a** in the RAN **104/113** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement a radio technology such as Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS) Terrestrial Radio Access (UTRA), which may establish the air interface **115/116/117** using wideband CDMA (WCDMA). WCDMA may include communication protocols such as High-Speed Packet Access (HSPA) and/or Evolved HSPA (HSPA+). HSPA may include High-Speed Downlink (DL) Packet Access (HSDPA) and/or High-

Speed UL Packet Access (HSUPA).

(21) In an embodiment, the base station **114a** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement a radio technology such as Evolved UMTS Terrestrial Radio Access (E-UTRA), which may establish the air interface **116** using Long Term Evolution (LTE) and/or LTE-Advanced (LTE-A) and/or LTE-Advanced Pro (LTE-A Pro).

(22) In an embodiment, the base station **114a** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement a radio technology such as NR Radio Access, which may establish the air interface **116** using New Radio (NR).

(23) In an embodiment, the base station **114a** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement multiple radio access technologies. For example, the base station **114a** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement LTE radio access and NR radio access together, for instance using dual connectivity (DC) principles. Thus, the air interface utilized by WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may be characterized by multiple types of radio access technologies and/or transmissions sent to/from multiple types of base stations (e.g., an eNB and a gNB).

(24) In other embodiments, the base station **114a** and the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement radio technologies such as IEEE 802.11 (i.e., Wireless Fidelity (WiFi)), IEEE 802.16 (i.e., Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX)), CDMA2000, CDMA2000 1X, CDMA2000 EV-DO, Interim Standard 2000 (IS-2000), Interim Standard 95 (IS-95), Interim Standard 856 (IS-856), Global System for Mobile communications (GSM), Enhanced Data rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE), GSM EDGE (GERAN), and the like.

(25) The base station **114b** in FIG. 1A may be a wireless router, Home Node B, Home eNode B, or access point, for example, and may utilize any suitable RAT for facilitating wireless connectivity in a localized area, such as a place of business, a home, a vehicle, a campus, an industrial facility, an air corridor (e.g., for use by drones), a roadway, and the like. In one embodiment, the base station **114b** and the WTRUs **102c**, **102d** may implement a radio technology such as IEEE 802.11 to establish a wireless local area network (WLAN). In an embodiment, the base station **114b** and the WTRUs **102c**, **102d** may implement a radio technology such as IEEE 802.15 to establish a wireless personal area network (WPAN). In yet another embodiment, the base station **114b** and the WTRUs **102c**, **102d** may utilize a cellular-based RAT (e.g., WCDMA, CDMA2000, GSM, LTE, LTE-A, LTE-A Pro, NR etc.) to establish a picocell or femtocell. As shown in FIG. 1A, the base station **114b** may have a direct connection to the Internet **110**. Thus, the base station **114b** may not be required to access the Internet **110** via the CN **106/115**.

(26) The RAN **104/113** may be in communication with the CN **106/115**, which may be any type of network configured to provide voice, data, applications, and/or voice over internet protocol (VoIP) services to one or more of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d**. The data may have varying quality of service (QoS) requirements, such as differing throughput requirements, latency requirements, error tolerance requirements, reliability requirements, data throughput requirements, mobility requirements, and the like. The CN **106/115** may provide call control, billing services, mobile location-based services, pre-paid calling, Internet connectivity, video distribution, etc., and/or perform high-level security functions, such as user authentication. Although not shown in FIG. 1A, it will be appreciated that the RAN **104/113** and/or the CN **106/115** may be in direct or indirect communication with other RANs that employ the same RAT as the RAN **104/113** or a different RAT. For example, in addition to being connected to the RAN **104/113**, which may be utilizing a NR radio technology, the CN **106/115** may also be in communication with another RAN (not shown) employing a GSM, UMTS, CDMA 2000, WiMAX, E-UTRA, or WiFi radio technology.

(27) The CN **106/115** may also serve as a gateway for the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** to access the PSTN **108**, the Internet **110**, and/or the other networks **112**. The PSTN **108** may include circuit-switched telephone networks that provide plain old telephone service (POTS). The Internet **110** may include a global system of interconnected computer networks and devices that use common communication protocols, such as the transmission control protocol (TCP), user datagram

protocol (UDP) and/or the internet protocol (IP) in the TCP/IP internet protocol suite. The networks **112** may include wired and/or wireless communications networks owned and/or operated by other service providers. For example, the networks **112** may include another CN connected to one or more RANs, which may employ the same RAT as the RAN **104/113** or a different RAT.

(28) Some or all of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** in the communications system **100** may include multi-mode capabilities (e.g., the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, **102d** may include multiple transceivers for communicating with different wireless networks over different wireless links). For example, the WTRU **102c** shown in FIG. 1A may be configured to communicate with the base station **114a**, which may employ a cellular-based radio technology, and with the base station **114b**, which may employ an IEEE 802 radio technology.

(29) FIG. 1B is a system diagram illustrating an example WTRU **102**. As shown in FIG. 1B, the WTRU **102** may include a processor **118**, a transceiver **120**, a transmit/receive element **122**, a speaker/microphone **124**, a keypad **126**, a display/touchpad **128**, non-removable memory **130**, removable memory **132**, a power source **134**, a global positioning system (GPS) chipset **136**, and/or other peripherals **138**, among others. It will be appreciated that the WTRU **102** may include any sub-combination of the foregoing elements while remaining consistent with an embodiment.

(30) The processor **118** may be a general purpose processor, a special purpose processor, a conventional processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in association with a DSP core, a controller, a microcontroller, Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs) circuits, any other type of integrated circuit (IC), a state machine, and the like. The processor **118** may perform signal coding, data processing, power control, input/output processing, and/or any other functionality that enables the WTRU **102** to operate in a wireless environment. The processor **118** may be coupled to the transceiver **120**, which may be coupled to the transmit/receive element **122**. While FIG. 1B depicts the processor **118** and the transceiver **120** as separate components, it will be appreciated that the processor **118** and the transceiver **120** may be integrated together in an electronic package or chip.

(31) The transmit/receive element **122** may be configured to transmit signals to, or receive signals from, a base station (e.g., the base station **114a**) over the air interface **116**. For example, in one embodiment, the transmit/receive element **122** may be an antenna configured to transmit and/or receive RF signals. In an embodiment, the transmit/receive element **122** may be an emitter/detector configured to transmit and/or receive IR, UV, or visible light signals, for example. In yet another embodiment, the transmit/receive element **122** may be configured to transmit and/or receive both RF and light signals. It will be appreciated that the transmit/receive element **122** may be configured to transmit and/or receive any combination of wireless signals.

(32) Although the transmit/receive element **122** is depicted in FIG. 1B as a single element, the WTRU **102** may include any number of transmit/receive elements **122**. More specifically, the WTRU **102** may employ MIMO technology. Thus, in one embodiment, the WTRU **102** may include two or more transmit/receive elements **122** (e.g., multiple antennas) for transmitting and receiving wireless signals over the air interface **116**.

(33) The transceiver **120** may be configured to modulate the signals that are to be transmitted by the transmit/receive element **122** and to demodulate the signals that are received by the transmit/receive element **122**. As noted above, the WTRU **102** may have multi-mode capabilities. Thus, the transceiver **120** may include multiple transceivers for enabling the WTRU **102** to communicate via multiple RATs, such as NR and IEEE 802.11, for example.

(34) The processor **118** of the WTRU **102** may be coupled to, and may receive user input data from, the speaker/microphone **124**, the keypad **126**, and/or the display/touchpad **128** (e.g., a liquid crystal display (LCD) display unit or organic light-emitting diode (OLED) display unit). The processor **118** may also output user data to the speaker/microphone **124**, the keypad **126**, and/or the display/touchpad **128**. In addition, the processor **118** may access information from, and store data

in, any type of suitable memory, such as the non-removable memory **130** and/or the removable memory **132**. The non-removable memory **130** may include random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), a hard disk, or any other type of memory storage device. The removable memory **132** may include a subscriber identity module (SIM) card, a memory stick, a secure digital (SD) memory card, and the like. In other embodiments, the processor **118** may access information from, and store data in, memory that is not physically located on the WTRU **102**, such as on a server or a home computer (not shown).

(35) The processor **118** may receive power from the power source **134**, and may be configured to distribute and/or control the power to the other components in the WTRU **102**. The power source **134** may be any suitable device for powering the WTRU **102**. For example, the power source **134** may include one or more dry cell batteries (e.g., nickel-cadmium (NiCd), nickel-zinc (NiZn), nickel metal hydride (NiMH), lithium-ion (Li-ion), etc.), solar cells, fuel cells, and the like.

(36) The processor **118** may also be coupled to the GPS chipset **136**, which may be configured to provide location information (e.g., longitude and latitude) regarding the current location of the WTRU **102**. In addition to, or in lieu of, the information from the GPS chipset **136**, the WTRU **102** may receive location information over the air interface **116** from a base station (e.g., base stations **114a**, **114b**) and/or determine its location based on the timing of the signals being received from two or more nearby base stations. It will be appreciated that the WTRU **102** may acquire location information by way of any suitable location-determination method while remaining consistent with an embodiment.

(37) The processor **118** may further be coupled to other peripherals **138**, which may include one or more software and/or hardware modules that provide additional features, functionality and/or wired or wireless connectivity. For example, the peripherals **138** may include an accelerometer, an e-compass, a satellite transceiver, a digital camera (for photographs and/or video), a universal serial bus (USB) port, a vibration device, a television transceiver, a hands free headset, a Bluetooth® module, a frequency modulated (FM) radio unit, a digital music player, a media player, a video game player module, an Internet browser, a Virtual Reality and/or Augmented Reality (VR/AR) device, an activity tracker, and the like. The peripherals **138** may include one or more sensors, the sensors may be one or more of a gyroscope, an accelerometer, a hall effect sensor, a magnetometer, an orientation sensor, a proximity sensor, a temperature sensor, a time sensor; a geolocation sensor; an altimeter, a light sensor, a touch sensor, a magnetometer, a barometer, a gesture sensor, a biometric sensor, and/or a humidity sensor.

(38) The processor **118** of the WTRU **102** may operatively communicate with various peripherals **138** including, for example, any of: the one or more accelerometers, the one or more gyroscopes, the USB port, other communication interfaces/ports, the display and/or other visual/audio indicators to implement representative embodiments disclosed herein.

(39) The WTRU **102** may include a full duplex radio for which transmission and reception of some or all of the signals (e.g., associated with particular subframes for both the UL (e.g., for transmission) and downlink (e.g., for reception) may be concurrent and/or simultaneous. The full duplex radio may include an interference management unit to reduce and or substantially eliminate self-interference via either hardware (e.g., a choke) or signal processing via a processor (e.g., a separate processor (not shown) or via processor **118**). In an embodiment, the WTRU **102** may include a half-duplex radio for which transmission and reception of some or all of the signals (e.g., associated with particular subframes for either the UL (e.g., for transmission) or the downlink (e.g., for reception).

(40) FIG. 1C is a system diagram illustrating the RAN **104** and the CN **106** according to an embodiment. As noted above, the RAN **104** may employ an E-UTRA radio technology to communicate with the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** over the air interface **116**. The RAN **104** may also be in communication with the CN **106**.

(41) The RAN **104** may include eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, though it will be appreciated that the

RAN **104** may include any number of eNode Bs while remaining consistent with an embodiment. The eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** may each include one or more transceivers for communicating with the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** over the air interface **116**. In one embodiment, the eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** may implement MIMO technology. Thus, the eNode B **160a**, for example, may use multiple antennas to transmit wireless signals to, and/or receive wireless signals from, the WTRU **102a**.

(42) Each of the eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** may be associated with a particular cell (not shown) and may be configured to handle radio resource management decisions, handover decisions, scheduling of users in the UL and/or DL, and the like. As shown in FIG. **1C**, the eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** may communicate with one another over an X2 interface.

(43) The CN **106** shown in FIG. **1C** may include a mobility management entity (MME) **162**, a serving gateway (SGW) **164**, and a packet data network (PDN) gateway (or PGW) **166**. While each of the foregoing elements are depicted as part of the CN **106**, it will be appreciated that any of these elements may be owned and/or operated by an entity other than the CN operator.

(44) The MME **162** may be connected to each of the eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** in the RAN **104** via an S1 interface and may serve as a control node. For example, the MME **162** may be responsible for authenticating users of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, bearer activation/deactivation, selecting a particular serving gateway during an initial attach of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, and the like. The MME **162** may provide a control plane function for switching between the RAN **104** and other RANs (not shown) that employ other radio technologies, such as GSM and/or WCDMA.

(45) The SGW **164** may be connected to each of the eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** in the RAN **104** via the S1 interface. The SGW **164** may generally route and forward user data packets to/from the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**. The SGW **164** may perform other functions, such as anchoring user planes during inter-eNode B handovers, triggering paging when DL data is available for the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, managing and storing contexts of the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**, and the like.

(46) The SGW **164** may be connected to the PGW **166**, which may provide the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** with access to packet-switched networks, such as the Internet **110**, to facilitate communications between the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** and IP-enabled devices.

(47) The CN **106** may facilitate communications with other networks. For example, the CN **106** may provide the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** with access to circuit-switched networks, such as the PSTN **108**, to facilitate communications between the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** and traditional land-line communications devices. For example, the CN **106** may include, or may communicate with, an IP gateway (e.g., an IP multimedia subsystem (IMS) server) that serves as an interface between the CN **106** and the PSTN **108**. In addition, the CN **106** may provide the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** with access to the other networks **112**, which may include other wired and/or wireless networks that are owned and/or operated by other service providers.

(48) Although the WTRU is described in FIGS. **1A-1D** as a wireless terminal, it is contemplated that in certain representative embodiments that such a terminal may use (e.g., temporarily or permanently) wired communication interfaces with the communication network.

(49) In representative embodiments, the other network **112** may be a WLAN.

(50) A WLAN in Infrastructure Basic Service Set (BSS) mode may have an Access Point (AP) for the BSS and one or more stations (STAs) associated with the AP. The AP may have an access or an interface to a Distribution System (DS) or another type of wired/wireless network that carries traffic in to and/or out of the BSS. Traffic to STAs that originates from outside the BSS may arrive through the AP and may be delivered to the STAs. Traffic originating from STAs to destinations outside the BSS may be sent to the AP to be delivered to respective destinations. Traffic between STAs within the BSS may be sent through the AP, for example, where the source STA may send traffic to the AP and the AP may deliver the traffic to the destination STA. The traffic between

STAs within a BSS may be considered and/or referred to as peer-to-peer traffic. The peer-to-peer traffic may be sent between (e.g., directly between) the source and destination STAs with a direct link setup (DLS). In certain representative embodiments, the DLS may use an 802.11e DLS or an 802.11z tunneled DLS (TDLS). A WLAN using an Independent BSS (IBSS) mode may not have an AP, and the STAs (e.g., all of the STAs) within or using the IBSS may communicate directly with each other. The IBSS mode of communication may sometimes be referred to herein as an “ad-hoc” mode of communication.

(51) When using the 802.11ac infrastructure mode of operation or a similar mode of operations, the AP may transmit a beacon on a fixed channel, such as a primary channel. The primary channel may be a fixed width (e.g., 20 MHz wide bandwidth) or a dynamically set width via signaling. The primary channel may be the operating channel of the BSS and may be used by the STAs to establish a connection with the AP. In certain representative embodiments, Carrier Sense Multiple Access with Collision Avoidance (CSMA/CA) may be implemented, for example in 802.11 systems. For CSMA/CA, the STAs (e.g., every STA), including the AP, may sense the primary channel. If the primary channel is sensed/detected and/or determined to be busy by a particular STA, the particular STA may back off. One STA (e.g., only one station) may transmit at any given time in a given BSS.

(52) High Throughput (HT) STAs may use a 40 MHz wide channel for communication, for example, via a combination of the primary 20 MHz channel with an adjacent or nonadjacent 20 MHz channel to form a 40 MHz wide channel.

(53) Very High Throughput (VHT) STAs may support 20 MHz, 40 MHz, 80 MHz, and/or 160 MHz wide channels. The 40 MHz, and/or 80 MHz, channels may be formed by combining contiguous 20 MHz channels. A 160 MHz channel may be formed by combining 8 contiguous 20 MHz channels, or by combining two non-contiguous 80 MHz channels, which may be referred to as an 80+80 configuration. For the 80+80 configuration, the data, after channel encoding, may be passed through a segment parser that may divide the data into two streams. Inverse Fast Fourier Transform (IFFT) processing, and time domain processing, may be done on each stream separately. The streams may be mapped on to the two 80 MHz channels, and the data may be transmitted by a transmitting STA. At the receiver of the receiving STA, the above described operation for the 80+80 configuration may be reversed, and the combined data may be sent to the Medium Access Control (MAC).

(54) Sub 1 GHz modes of operation are supported by 802.11af and 802.11ah. The channel operating bandwidths, and carriers, are reduced in 802.11af and 802.11ah relative to those used in 802.11n, and 802.11ac. 802.11af supports 5 MHz, 10 MHz and 20 MHz bandwidths in the TV White Space (TVWS) spectrum, and 802.11ah supports 1 MHz, 2 MHz, 4 MHz, 8 MHz, and 16 MHz bandwidths using non-TVWS spectrum. According to a representative embodiment, 802.11ah may support Meter Type Control/Machine-Type Communications, such as MTC devices in a macro coverage area. MTC devices may have certain capabilities, for example, limited capabilities including support for (e.g., only support for) certain and/or limited bandwidths. The MTC devices may include a battery with a battery life above a threshold (e.g., to maintain a very long battery life).

(55) WLAN systems, which may support multiple channels, and channel bandwidths, such as 802.11n, 802.11ac, 802.11af, and 802.11ah, include a channel which may be designated as the primary channel. The primary channel may have a bandwidth equal to the largest common operating bandwidth supported by all STAs in the BSS. The bandwidth of the primary channel may be set and/or limited by a STA, from among all STAs in operating in a BSS, which supports the smallest bandwidth operating mode. In the example of 802.11ah, the primary channel may be 1 MHz wide for STAs (e.g., MTC type devices) that support (e.g., only support) a 1 MHz mode, even if the AP, and other STAs in the BSS support 2 MHz, 4 MHz, 8 MHz, 16 MHz, and/or other channel bandwidth operating modes. Carrier sensing and/or Network Allocation Vector (NAV)

settings may depend on the status of the primary channel. If the primary channel is busy, for example, due to a STA (which supports only a 1 MHz operating mode), transmitting to the AP, the entire available frequency bands may be considered busy even though a majority of the frequency bands remains idle and may be available.

(56) In the United States, the available frequency bands, which may be used by 802.11ah, are from 902 MHz to 928 MHz. In Korea, the available frequency bands are from 917.5 MHz to 923.5 MHz. In Japan, the available frequency bands are from 916.5 MHz to 927.5 MHz. The total bandwidth available for 802.11ah is 6 MHz to 26 MHz depending on the country code.

(57) FIG. 1D is a system diagram illustrating the RAN **113** and the CN **115** according to an embodiment. As noted above, the RAN **113** may employ an NR radio technology to communicate with the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** over the air interface **116**. The RAN **113** may also be in communication with the CN **115**.

(58) The RAN **113** may include gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c**, though it will be appreciated that the RAN **113** may include any number of gNBs while remaining consistent with an embodiment. The gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may each include one or more transceivers for communicating with the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** over the air interface **116**. In one embodiment, the gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may implement MIMO technology. For example, gNBs **180a**, **180b** may utilize beamforming to transmit signals to and/or receive signals from the gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c**. Thus, the gNB **180a**, for example, may use multiple antennas to transmit wireless signals to, and/or receive wireless signals from, the WTRU **102a**. In an embodiment, the gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may implement carrier aggregation technology. For example, the gNB **180a** may transmit multiple component carriers to the WTRU **102a** (not shown). A subset of these component carriers may be on unlicensed spectrum while the remaining component carriers may be on licensed spectrum. In an embodiment, the gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may implement Coordinated Multi-Point (COMP) technology. For example, WTRU **102a** may receive coordinated transmissions from gNB **180a** and gNB **180b** (and/or gNB **180c**).

(59) The WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may communicate with gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** using transmissions associated with a scalable numerology. For example, the OFDM symbol spacing and/or OFDM subcarrier spacing may vary for different transmissions, different cells, and/or different portions of the wireless transmission spectrum. The WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may communicate with gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** using subframe or transmission time intervals (TTIs) of various or scalable lengths (e.g., containing varying number of OFDM symbols and/or lasting varying lengths of absolute time).

(60) The gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may be configured to communicate with the WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** in a standalone configuration and/or a non-standalone configuration. In the standalone configuration, WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may communicate with gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** without also accessing other RANs (e.g., such as eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c**). In the standalone configuration, WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may utilize one or more of gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** as a mobility anchor point. In the standalone configuration, WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may communicate with gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** using signals in an unlicensed band. In a non-standalone configuration WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may communicate with/connect to gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** while also communicating with/connecting to another RAN such as eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c**. For example, WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** may implement DC principles to communicate with one or more gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** and one or more eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** substantially simultaneously. In the non-standalone configuration, eNode Bs **160a**, **160b**, **160c** may serve as a mobility anchor for WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c** and gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may provide additional coverage and/or throughput for servicing WTRUs **102a**, **102b**, **102c**.

(61) Each of the gNBs **180a**, **180b**, **180c** may be associated with a particular cell (not shown) and may be configured to handle radio resource management decisions, handover decisions, scheduling of users in the UL and/or DL, support of network slicing, dual connectivity, interworking between

NR and E-UTRA, routing of user plane data towards User Plane Function (UPF) **184a, 184b**, routing of control plane information towards Access and Mobility Management Function (AMF) **182a, 182b** and the like. As shown in FIG. 1D, the gNBs **180a, 180b, 180c** may communicate with one another over an Xn interface.

(62) The CN **115** shown in FIG. 1D may include at least one AMF **182a, 182b**, at least one UPF **184a, 184b**, at least one Session Management Function (SMF) **183a, 183b**, and possibly a Data Network (DN) **185a, 185b**. While each of the foregoing elements are depicted as part of the CN **115**, it will be appreciated that any of these elements may be owned and/or operated by an entity other than the CN operator. The AMF **182a, 182b** may be connected to one or more of the gNBs **180a, 180b, 180c** in the RAN **113** via an N2 interface and may serve as a control node. For example, the AMF **182a, 182b** may be responsible for authenticating users of the WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c**, support for network slicing (e.g., handling of different Protocol Data Unit (PDU) sessions with different requirements), selecting a particular SMF **183a, 183b**, management of the registration area, termination of Non-Access Stratum (NAS) signaling, mobility management, and the like. Network slicing may be used by the AMF **182a, 182b** in order to customize CN support for WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c** based on the types of services being utilized WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c**. For example, different network slices may be established for different use cases such as services relying on ultra-reliable low latency communication (URLLC) access, services relying on enhanced mobile (e.g., massive mobile) broadband (eMBB) access, services for machine type communication (MTC) access, and/or the like. The AMF **162** may provide a control plane function for switching between the RAN **113** and other RANs (not shown) that employ other radio technologies, such as LTE, LTE-A, LTE-A Pro, and/or non-3GPP access technologies such as WiFi.

(63) The SMF **183a, 183b** may be connected to an AMF **182a, 182b** in the CN **115** via an N11 interface. The SMF **183a, 183b** may also be connected to a UPF **184a, 184b** in the CN **115** via an N4 interface. The SMF **183a, 183b** may select and control the UPF **184a, 184b** and configure the routing of traffic through the UPF **184a, 184b**. The SMF **183a, 183b** may perform other functions, such as managing and allocating WTRU/UE IP address, managing PDU sessions, controlling policy enforcement and QoS, providing downlink data notifications, and the like. A PDU session type may be IP-based, non-IP based, Ethernet-based, and the like.

(64) The UPF **184a, 184b** may be connected to one or more of the gNBs **180a, 180b, 180c** in the RAN **113** via an N3 interface, which may provide the WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c** with access to packet-switched networks, such as the Internet **110**, to facilitate communications between the WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c** and IP-enabled devices. The UPF **184, 184b** may perform other functions, such as routing and forwarding packets, enforcing user plane policies, supporting multi-homed PDU sessions, handling user plane QoS, buffering downlink packets, providing mobility anchoring, and the like.

(65) The CN **115** may facilitate communications with other networks. For example, the CN **115** may include, or may communicate with, an IP gateway (e.g., an IP multimedia subsystem (IMS) server) that serves as an interface between the CN **115** and the PSTN **108**. In addition, the CN **115** may provide the WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c** with access to the other networks **112**, which may include other wired and/or wireless networks that are owned and/or operated by other service providers. In one embodiment, the WTRUs **102a, 102b, 102c** may be connected to a local Data Network (DN) **185a, 185b** through the UPF **184a, 184b** via the N3 interface to the UPF **184a, 184b** and an N6 interface between the UPF **184a, 184b** and the DN **185a, 185b**.

(66) In view of FIGS. 1A-1D, and the corresponding description of FIGS. 1A-1D, one or more, or all, of the functions described herein with regard to one or more of: WTRU **102a-d**, Base Station **114a-b**, eNode B **160a-c**, MME **162**, SGW **164**, PGW **166**, gNB **180a-c**, AMF **182a-b**, UPF **184a-b**, SMF **183a-b**, DN **185a-b**, and/or any other device(s) described herein, may be performed by one or more emulation devices (not shown). The emulation devices may be one or more devices configured to emulate one or more, or all, of the functions described herein. For example, the

emulation devices may be used to test other devices and/or to simulate network and/or WTRU functions.

(67) The emulation devices may be designed to implement one or more tests of other devices in a lab environment and/or in an operator network environment. For example, the one or more emulation devices may perform the one or more, or all, functions while being fully or partially implemented and/or deployed as part of a wired and/or wireless communication network in order to test other devices within the communication network. The one or more emulation devices may perform the one or more, or all, functions while being temporarily implemented/deployed as part of a wired and/or wireless communication network. The emulation device may be directly coupled to another device for purposes of testing and/or may performing testing using over-the-air wireless communications.

(68) The one or more emulation devices may perform the one or more, including all, functions while not being implemented/deployed as part of a wired and/or wireless communication network. For example, the emulation devices may be utilized in a testing scenario in a testing laboratory and/or a non-deployed (e.g., testing) wired and/or wireless communication network in order to implement testing of one or more components. The one or more emulation devices may be test equipment. Direct RF coupling and/or wireless communications via RF circuitry (e.g., which may include one or more antennas) may be used by the emulation devices to transmit and/or receive data.

(69) In certain representative embodiments, methods, system, apparatus operations, functions and/or procedures may be implemented to enable distance dependent RACH preamble groupings (e.g., using propagation delay related information (e.g., (1) an absolute propagation delay, (2) relative propagation delay, for example which may be a propagation delay difference relative to the nadir, (3) a distance from a WTRU to its NAP, and/or (4) a distance from the WTRU to a nadir or the NAP), among others.

(70) In certain representative embodiments, methods, system, apparatus operations, functions and/or procedures may be implemented to enable a selection of a RACH root sequence for determining a RACH preamble (e.g., using propagation delay related information (e.g., (1) an absolute propagation delay, (2) relative propagation delay, for example which may be a propagation delay difference relative to the nadir, (3) a distance from a WTRU to its NAP, and/or (4) a distance from the WTRU to a nadir or the NAP), among others.

(71) In certain representative embodiments, methods, system, apparatus operations, functions and/or procedures may be implemented to enable an RA-RNTI as a function of, derived from or including the propagation delay related information.

(72) Representative Procedures for Distance Dependent Random Access Response (RAR) Decoding

(73) Satellite systems play a part (e.g., an invaluable part) in enabling communications, for example in places where the last mile of fiber cable or terrestrial WTRU telephony is unviable. Satellite services may be considered supplementary to terrestrial cellular and land-based communication systems. Satellite services have historically facilitated broadcast applications such as television and provided emergency, essential services to offshore oil-rigs and shipping industries. Satellites may provide broadband (e.g., true broadband) connectivity to terrestrial users complementing land-based WTRU and fixed wireless systems. The volume of users utilizing satellite based services is limited to those (e.g., just those) who can afford the services or who have no other alternatives. For Satellites to become a pervasive and viable technology, the volume of users that can be supported should increase and unicast services in addition to existing broadcast services should become more prevalent. With an increase in user count, the volume of data serviceable may increase almost linearly.

(74) Satellites may occupy one of several orbital classes. In the low earth orbit (LEO) class, satellites are typically at altitudes of about 400 to 2,000 kilometers with a common altitude of about

700 kilometers. In the medium earth orbit (MEO) class, satellites are typically at altitudes of about 2000 to 32,000 kilometers with a common altitude of about 20,000 kilometers. In the geo-synchronous (GSO) or geo-stationary orbit (GEO), the satellites may be quasi-fixed at approximately 36,000 kilometers. With higher altitudes, propagation delay and power budgets may be the issue (e.g., the main issue) while with lower altitudes, doppler and mobility may be the issue (e.g., the main issue). With lower orbits, the satellites experience atmospheric drag and per Kepler's laws of planetary motion, the lower the orbital altitude, the higher the angular velocity of the satellite.

(75) To dimension systems with good and/or acceptable link budgets, it is likely that commercial communications satellites may be either LEO or MEO in the medium term and on very high frequencies. With very high velocity satellites, the doppler may be very high and this may pose issues with synchronization and time for fix. Satellite link budgets may be provided (e.g., built) with high link margins to overcome rain and/or other atmospheric aberrations that may arise during a communication. Despite this, the Signal-to-Interference-Plus-Noise Ratio (SINR) experienced and/or measured on the downlink and/or the uplink may be low (e.g., low enough) that, for example the highest modulation-coding schemes employed in satellite links may be several orders lower than what is comparable in terrestrial systems. The long propagation delays involving satellite links may be several orders larger than observed in a terrestrial system. The long propagation delays may pose issues enforcing efficient power control loops, which may cause the satellite terminals and ground stations to perform with incorrectly set operating points.

(76) Satellite links, though reliable, may suffer from high latencies. Services that use TCP as the transport layer may be susceptible (e.g., especially susceptible) to latency and performance may degrade accordingly.

(77) Representative Procedures for RRC Connection Establishment from IDLE

(78) FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating a representative RRC connection establishment procedure. Referring to FIG. 2, in the RRC connection procedure **200**, the WTRU **102** may enter RRC connected state after a 4-way signaling exchange of information. For example, at **220**, system information may be broadcast from an eNodeB, agNB **180**, a satellite S, a base station (BS), a ground station **310B** (for example, collectively referred to a Network Access Point (NAP) **210**). At **230**, the WTRU **102** may perform DL synchronization and may read the master information and/or system information blocks to determine the viability of the system. The WTRU **102** may estimate the open loop transmit power to be used and/or required after measuring a candidate cell's reference signal or pilot signal received power and an advertised DL transmit power. At **240**, the WTRU **102** may transmit Message 1 (MSG1) to the NAP **210** that may include a RACH preamble (e.g., using, masked and/or scrambled by a Random Access-Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI)). At **250**, the NAP **210** may detect the RACH preamble and may determine a Timing Advance (TA) estimation. At **260**, the NAP may transmit to the WTRU **102** a Message 2 (MSG2). The MSG2 may include or may indicate a TA, a power correction, an UL grant and/or a temporary Cell Radio Network Temporary Identifier (T-CRNTI), among others. At **270**, the WTRU **102** may transmit to the NAP **210**, a Message 3 (MSG3). The MSG3 may include or may indicate a RRC connection request and a WTRU ID. At **280**, the NAP **210** may transmit to the WTRU **102** a Message 4 (MSG4). The MSG4 may include a contention resolution (e.g., a contention resolution indication).

(79) In certain representative embodiments, the RA-RNTI may be established as a function of, derived from or may include a propagation delay related parameter or propagation delay related information.

(80) In certain representative embodiments, the preamble sent in MSG1 may be selected based on a propagation delay related parameter or propagation delay related information.

(81) For example, the NAP **210** may broadcast a CAZAC root sequence index and any cyclic shift restrictions that may apply in a cell. The WTRU **102** may generate a plurality of preambles (e.g., 64 preambles) using the CAZAC root sequence and/or additional CAZAC root sequences, for example

depending on the cyclic shift restrictions that may apply in the cell. The WTRU **102** may select one preamble from among a superset of preambles available and may transmit the sequence (e.g., in the MSG1) at a power level determined by an open loop setting (e.g., based on the open loop estimation). If the NAP **210** received and estimated the preamble correctly, the NAP **210** may determine the amount of shift in the received preamble and the associated propagation delay. The NAP **210** may convert the propagation delay into a TA and may determine if the WTRU **102** needs to and/or is to perform any power correction.

(82) FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a representative NTN showing a variance in propagation delay inside a spot-beam.

(83) Referring to FIG. 3, for a NTN **300**, the NAP **210** may be on an orbit several hundreds to several thousands of kilometers (kms) above earth. For example, if a NTN NAP **210** is determined to be on a circular orbit of 3,000 km above earth, the one-way propagation delay is about 10 milliseconds to the nadir on earth. In FIG. 3 D.sub.A may equal 3000 km and may represent the distance to the nadir and Terminal A (e.g., a WTRU **102A** and/or a ground station **310A**) may be at located at the nadir. Terminal A may experience a one-way propagation delay of about 10 ms. If the minimum serviceable elevation angle is 45 degrees, and Terminal B (e.g., another WTRU **102B** and/or a ground station **310B**) is at an edge of the spot beam **320** and corresponds to an elevation angle θ (e.g., an elevation angle θ of 45 degrees), using Pythagorean theorem, Terminal A **102A/310A** and Terminal B **102B/310B** can be separated by 3,000 km. For this example, the curvature of the earth has been discounted (e.g., not considered) and the earth may be assumed to be a flat surface. The distance D.sub.B between the Terminal B **102B/310B** and the NAP **210** may be equal to 4242.6 km and the one-way propagation delay over the distance D.sub.B equals about 14.14 milliseconds. There may be a large variation in propagation delay within the spot beam **320** (e.g., in a range between 10 ms and 14.14 ms for the example shown in FIG. 3. This variance may increase as the minimum elevation angle decreases. Typically, satellites/NTN NAPs **210** can have a serviceable elevation angle as low as, for example about 10 degrees.

(84) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating a representative TA procedure.

(85) Referring to FIG. 4, the TA procedure **400** may include the WTRU **102** performing (e.g., first performing) downlink synchronization with a BS and/or NAP **210** before performing network access (e.g., any network access). For example, the uplink and downlink radio frames may be synchronized based on the propagation delay. The TA for the WTRU **102** may be set to 2*the propagation delay.

(86) For example, on the uplink, the BS/NAP **210** may expect to receive all transmissions from scheduled WTRUs **102** (e.g., all scheduled WTRUs **102**) for a specific interval (e.g., transmission time interval (TTI)) to be time aligned as shown in FIG. 4. To compensate for a variance in propagation time for the various WTRUs **102** in the coverage area (e.g., spot coverage area), the BS/NAP **210** may inform the WTRUs **102** (e.g., each WTRU **102**) of Timing Advance (TA) information (e.g., a TA value). The TA value may be the time-unit by which a WTRU **102** advances its uplink transmission so that its uplink frame arrives time-aligned with other uplink transmissions from other WTRUs **102**. A variation (e.g., large variation and/or a variation that is above a threshold) in propagation delay within the spot beam **320** may cause the NAP **210** (e.g., the satellite or other aerial device) to falsely detect a received preamble. Representative procedures to address this false detection may be realized by applying cyclic shift restrictions. Such procedures may increase the processing load at the BS/NAP **210**.

(87) In certain representative embodiments, methods, systems, apparatus, operations, functions and/or procedures may be implemented to negate the propagation delay variance that would exist in such spot beams **320**, for example such that the TA may be reliably estimated for a NTN BS/NAP **210**.

(88) Representative Procedures for Distance Dependent RACH Preamble Grouping

(89) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a position estimation with respect to a nadir of a NTN.

(90) Referring to FIG. 5, in the NTN **500**, a spot beam **510** (e.g., circular or elliptical with low eccentricity) may be split into several concentrically enclosed sub-spot beams **520**, **530**, **540**. The center of the spot beam is the nadir of the satellite (e.g., right below the BS/NAP **210**). The minimum propagation delay between the satellite/BS/NAP **210** and a WTRU **102**/ground station **310** within the spot beam **510** occurs at the center (e.g., the nadir N) of the spot beam **510** (e.g., at the nadir N of the satellite/NAP **210** (located at S).

(91) The minimum elevation angle, $\theta_{\text{sub.1}}$ in FIG. 5 may be a design parameter and may be known to the satellite/NAP **210** and the WTRUs **102** in the spot beam **510**. The minimum elevation angle may be signaled to the WTRUs **102** over an air interface, for example over or via system information. The position S of a satellite may be estimated by the WTRU **102** based on information broadcast in system information. For example, the absolute transmission time of a particular system information block corresponding to the {SFN, SF} in which it is transmitted may be included as Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) in the system information. It is contemplated that based on a difference between the received and transmitted timestamps, the WTRU **102** may estimate the propagation delay to the satellite/NAP **210** while at position S. From two or more such transmissions from the satellite/NAP **210** while at positions $S(t)$, $S(t+\Delta t)$, $S(t+2\Delta t)$, . . . $S(t+2n\Delta t)$ (e.g., where n is an integer number), the WTRU **102** may determine a distance and/or a trajectory of the satellite/NAP **210** based on periodic reception of such information. In certain representative embodiments, the satellite/NAP **210** may broadcast its GNSS coordinates, for example periodically as part of the system information.

(92) A WTRU **102** at an arbitrary position A within the spot beam **510** may estimate a position S of the satellite (e.g., NAP **210**) and the distance $D_{\text{sub.A}}$ to the position S of the satellite/NAP **210** and/or a corresponding interior angle $\theta_{\text{sub.2}}$ the WTRU **102** makes with the satellite/NAP **210**. Since point N is the nadir of the satellite/NAP **210** (e.g., which refers to the perpendicular from point S to point N), the complementary angle $\theta_{\text{sub.3}}$ may be determined. With a determination of the angles $\theta_{\text{sub.2}}$ and/or $\theta_{\text{sub.3}}$ that point A forms with S and the hypotenuse $D_{\text{sub.A}}$ (which may be the propagation distance), the distance between point A and N, AN and/or the distance from S and N, $SN=D_{\text{sub.min}}$ may be determined. The associated propagation delays to cover distances $D_{\text{sub.min}}$ and/or $D_{\text{sub.A}}$ may be determined.

(93) For example, it is contemplated that a variation in one-way propagation delay may exist for values (e.g., for all continuous values) between distance $D_{\text{sub.min}}$ and distance $D_{\text{sub.max}}$. If two WTRUs **102**, one at point N and the other at point B, choose (for example via a uniformly and random selection procedure) and transmit an identically shifted CAZAC cyclic sequence, the NAP **210** in position S may falsely detect one of the preambles due to the large variance between these distances (e.g., distance $D_{\text{sub.min}}$ and distance $D_{\text{sub.max}}$). The same outcome may be true for any two WTRUs **102**, one a first position (e.g., at position N) inside the spot beam **510** and the other at any arbitrary position A inside the spot beam **510**. Without loss of generality, the problem with varying magnitude (e.g., varying propagation delay timing) may exist for any two or more WTRUs **102** at arbitrary positions A, $A_{\text{sup.1}}$ etc. within the spot beam **510**. The problem may be less emphasized when the distance between A, $A_{\text{sup.1}}$ is relatively short (e.g., less than a threshold difference in propagation delay) and the problem may be more emphasized more when the distance between A and $A_{\text{sup.1}}$ is relatively large (e.g., more than the threshold difference in propagation delay).

(94) In certain representative embodiments, a WTRU **102** at position A may be instructed to determine its relative distance to point N and depending on the distance to point N, the WTRU **102** may select (e.g., may be forced to select) from a subset of available preambles. For example, the propagation delay difference, $\delta_{\text{sub.A}}$, for a WTRU **102** at point A compared with the minimum propagation delay $D_{\text{sub.min}}$ may be set forth in Equation 1, as follows.

(95)
$$A = \frac{D_A - D_{\text{min}}}{\text{speedoflight}} \quad (1)$$

(96) The total set of preambles $\{P\}$ available in a spot beam **510** may be split into T orthogonal sets conforming to properties set forth in Equations 2 and 3, as follows.

(97)

$$\{P_1\}, \{P_2\}, \dots, \{P_T\} \mid \{P_I\} \cap \{P_J\} = \{\emptyset\}; (I, J) \in \{1, 2, \dots, T\} \text{ and } I \neq J \quad (2)$$

$$\{P_1\} \cap \{P_2\} \cap \dots \cap \{P_T\} = \{P^1\} \subset \{P\} \quad (3)$$

(98) The size of each subset may be different and may or may not be equal, (e.g., the number of preambles in one subset $P_{\text{sub.1}}$ may be equal to or more or less than $P_{\text{sub.J}}$). It is contemplated that $P_{\text{sub.1}}$ is a subset or a proper-subset of P , e.g., some of the subsets may not be used by the BS/NAP **210**, if the BS/NAP **210** chooses/determines and/or may be reserved for dedicated usage. The WTRUs **102** may be signaled to choose/determine a preamble from the specific subset $P_{\text{sub.1}}$, $I \in \{1, 2, \dots, T\}$ based on the formulation set forth in Equation 4.

$$\text{Selectfrom } P_1 \text{ if } A < \text{THR}_1$$

$$\text{Selectfrom } P_2 \text{ if } \text{THR}_1 \leq A < \text{THR}_2$$

$$(99) \text{ Preamble} = \text{Uniformlyrandom}\{ \text{Selectfrom } P_3 \text{ if } \text{THR}_2 \leq A < \text{THR}_3 \quad (4)$$

.Math.

$$\text{Selectfrom } P_T \text{ if } \text{THR}_{T-1} \leq A$$

(100) The WTRU **102** may estimate distance $D_{\text{sub.min}}$ and/or distance $D_{\text{sub.A}}$ without ambiguity (e.g., any ambiguity). The propagation delay difference $\delta_{\text{sub.A}}$ may be estimated from Equation 1. Depending on the threshold value of the propagation delay difference $\delta_{\text{sub.A}}$, the WTRU **102** may select the preamble using Equation 4 and may transmit the preamble to the NTN (e.g., the NAP **210**). In certain representative embodiments, since NTN knows that the WTRU **102** is to choose a preamble from a subset of preambles (e.g., a randomly selected preamble from only a subset of given preambles associated with the position A of the WTRU **102** in the spot beam **510**) based on its relative position to the nadir (e.g., the point N), there is no confusion about the impact of differential propagation delay in the received shifted sequence.

(101) In one embodiment, the WTRU **102** may be preconfigured to automatically determine the preamble subsets and associated propagation delay difference thresholds if not signaled explicitly by the gNB **180**/NAP **210** (e.g., a network entity). For example, a procedure may be implemented to enable the WTRU **102** to have the preamble subsets and associated thresholds be preconfigured in the mobile equipment (ME) and/or the Universal Subscriber Identity Modules (USIM). The procedure may enable the WTRU **102** to be configured (e.g., at the WTRU **102**) by a network entity (e.g., a gNB **180** and/or a NAP **210**) via an application layer over any communication media. The gNB **180** may signal a parameter, for example PREAMBLESET_INDICATOR, via the system information or via dedicated signaling to the WTRU **102**. The PREAMBLESET_INDICATOR may instruct the WTRU **102** on how to determine the preamble subsets and associated thresholds. The PREAMBLESET_INDICATOR, for example, may be a scalar value encoding an integer or a bit-string, although other formats are also possible and not precluded.

(102) As one example, PREAMBLESET_INDICATOR=1 may indicate the WTRU **102** to select Procedure $\# \{1\}$ in its stored memory. Procedure $\# \{1\}$ may pre-define splitting 64 preambles into 8 equal sets $\{P_{\text{sub.1}}, P_{\text{sub.2}}, \dots, P_{\text{sub.8}}\}$ of 8 preambles each. Procedure $\# \{1\}$ may map $\{P_{\text{sub.1}}, P_{\text{sub.2}}, \dots, P_{\text{sub.8}}\}$ to thresholds $\{\text{THR}_1=500 \mu\text{s}, \text{THR}_2=900 \mu\text{s}, \dots, \text{THR}_8=4800 \mu\text{s}\}$. The definition included in and/or contained in Procedure $\# \{1\}$ may be known a priori at the WTRU **102** and the gNB **180**/NAP **210**. The WTRU **102** may be preconfigured with U procedures (e.g., U different procedures), Procedure $\# \{1, 2, \dots, U\}$ with each Procedure $\# \{l\}$, $l \in \{1, 2, \dots, U\}$, representing a particular way of forming preamble sets and deriving the corresponding delay difference thresholds. In certain representative embodiments, the values selected for the thresholds may correspond to distances of the WTRU **102** from the nadir N . One of skill understands that any

threshold THR1, THR2 . . . THRN may correspond to a value set in accordance with propagation delay range associated with a WTRU that is located within the spotbeam. The thresholds THR1, THR2 . . . THRN may change based on satellite/NAP orbit/aerial path above earth's surface and beam coverage.

(103) Representative Procedures for Selection of Distance Dependent RACH Root Sequence

(104) In certain representative embodiments, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may choose and/or determine to apply different RACH root sequences to the WTRUs **102** based on a location of the WTRUs **102**. If the gNB **180**/NAP **210** chooses/determines to operate T RACH root sequences with root sequence indices {R.sub.1, R.sub.2, . . . , R.sub.T}. The WTRU **102** may be signaled to choose/select a root sequence index R.sub.I, $I \in T$ based on the formulation set forth in Equation 5.

$$(105) \text{ Rootindex} = \begin{cases} R_1 & \text{if } A < \text{THR}_1 \\ R_2 & \text{if } \text{THR}_1 \leq A < \text{THR}_2 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ R_T & \text{if } \text{THR}_{T-1} \leq A \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

.Math.

(106) The WTRU **102** may estimate distance D.sub.min, distance D.sub.A and/or propagation delay (e.g., propagation delay difference) δ .sub.A. Depending on the threshold value of the propagation delay difference δ .sub.A, the WTRU **102** may select the RACH root sequence index using Equation 5.

(107) Subsequent to the selection of the root sequence index, the WTRU **102** may generate a length Q CAZAC sequence. For example, Q may be set to 837 for NR and/or LTE. The WTRU **102** may generate **64** cyclically shifted preambles with the given root. The WTRU **102** may uniformly and randomly select a preamble and may transmit the selected preamble to the NTN **300/500**. The WTRU **102** may exclude from the 64 preambles any preambles reserved for dedicated use. The preambles reserved for dedicated use may be signaled to the WTRU **102** by the gNB **180**/NAP **210**, for example in system information or via RRC dedicated signaling. The gNB **180**/NAP **210** may determine and/or choose to apply cyclic shift restrictions, as appropriate, for various representative embodiments.

(108) In certain representative embodiments, additional root sequence indices may be determined, for example based on a primary RACH root sequence index R.sub.I, $I \in T$ selected in Equation 5. For example, the WTRU **102** may be preconfigured to automatically determine the RACH root sequence set and associated propagation delay difference thresholds if not signaled explicitly by the gNB **180**/NAP **210**. The primary RACH root sequence index may be (e.g., may always be) signaled to the WTRU **102**. The WTRU **102** may be configured with a procedure a priori (e.g., preconfigured) in the ME/USIM on how to determine the RACH root sequence set and/or associated thresholds. The procedure may be configured at the WTRU **102** by the network via the application layer over any communication media. The gNB **180**/NAP **210** may signal a parameter, for example RSASET_INDICATOR, via system information and/or via dedicated signaling to the WTRU **102**. The RSASET_INDICATOR parameter may instruct the WTRU **102** on how to determine the RACH root sequence set and/or associated thresholds. The RSASET_INDICATOR parameter, for example, may be a scalar value encoding an integer or a bit-string though other formats are possible and are not precluded.

(109) As one example, RSASET_INDICATOR=1 may indicate that the WTRU **102** is to select Procedure #{1} in the stored memory of the WTRU **102**. Procedure #{1} may pre-define forming a set of 4 RACH root indices as follows: {R.sub.1, R.sub.1+A, R.sub.1+B, R.sub.1+C} where R.sub.1 is the primary RACH root sequence index signaled via system information by the gNB **180**/NAP **210** and integers {A, B, C} are predefined for Procedure #{1}. Procedure #{1} may map {R.sub.1, R.sub.2, R.sub.3, R.sub.4} to thresholds {THR1=500 μ s, THR2=900 μ s, . . . THR4=2000 μ s}. The definition included in and/or contained in Procedure ##{1} may be known a priori at the

WTRUs **102** and the gNB **180**/NAP **210** (e.g., the BS). The WTRU **102** may be preconfigured with U procedures (e.g., U different procedures), Procedure $\#\{1, 2, \dots, U\}$ with each Procedure $\#\{I\}$, $I \in \{1, 2, \dots, U\}$, representing a particular way of forming RACH root sequence sets and/or deriving the corresponding delay difference thresholds.

(110) Representative Procedures for Determination of Sub-Spot Beams

(111) The sub-spot beams **520**, **530**, and **540** (e.g., annual rings) (for example may be defined by and/or set based on differential propagation delays δ estimated using the formula in Equation 1 (and/or using a formula that also takes into account the curvature of the Earth and/or the altitude of the WTRU **102**). Depending on the exact differential propagation delay δ and/or the associated threshold settings, the WTRU **102** may select a RACH preamble set and/or a RACH root sequence.

(112) In certain representative embodiments, the satellite/NAP **210** may employ differential distance thresholds ψ . For example, the WTRU **102A** may have a GNSS receiver allowing it to estimate its position (X.sub.A, Y.sub.A) on a coordinate plane (e.g., where (X, Y) refer to the latitude and longitude). The nadir of the satellite/NAP **210** may be estimated by the WTRU **102A** (e.g., at location A) as (X.sub.N, Y.sub.N) using procedures described herein. The distance $\psi_{\text{sub.A}} = \sqrt{(X_{\text{sub.A}} - X_{\text{sub.N}})^2 + (Y_{\text{sub.A}} - Y_{\text{sub.N}})^2}$ refers to the distance between the WTRU **102A** and the nadir N of a satellite/NAP **210**. The satellite/NAP **210** may choose and/or determine to define sub-spot beams **520**, **530** and **540** based on differential distances using the nadir N as a reference. In this case, Equation 4 may be modified to Equation 6, which is set forth as follows.

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{Selectfrom } P_1 \text{ if } \psi_A < \text{DistTHR}_1 \\
 & \text{Selectfrom } P_2 \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_1 \leq \psi_A < \text{DistTHR}_2 \\
 (113) \quad \text{Preamble} = & \text{Uniformlyrandom}\{ \text{Selectfrom } P_3 \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_2 \leq \psi_A < \text{DistTHR}_3 \quad (6) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & \text{Selectfrom } P_T \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_{T-1} \leq \psi_A
 \end{aligned}$$

where the specific subset P.sub.I, $I \in \{1, 2, \dots, T\}$, are defined earlier and the DistTHR.sub.I, $I \in \{1, 2, \dots, T\}$, are the distance thresholds with respect to the nadir. For example, if the satellite chooses and/or determines to assign different root sequences to the sub-spot beams (e.g., sub-spot beams **520**, **530** and **540**), Equation 5 may be modified to Equation 7, which is set forth as follows.

$$\begin{aligned}
 & R_1 \text{ if } \psi_A < \text{DistTHR}_1 \\
 (114) \quad \text{Rootindex} = & \{ R_2 \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_1 \leq \psi_A < \text{DistTHR}_2 \quad (7) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & R_T \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_{T-1} \leq \psi_A
 \end{aligned}$$

(115) FIG. 6 is an overall flowchart illustrating a representative procedure for selection of distance dependent RACH preambles in an NTN. Certain procedures set forth herein uses portions of this representative procedure **600**. Referring the FIG. 6, the representative procedure may include, at block **605**, the WTRU **102** obtaining preamble subsets, root sequence sets, propagation delay thresholds (e.g., propagation delay differential thresholds) from the ME and/or the USIM, on condition that such information is broadcast in SI and/or RRC signaled. Alternatively, at block **610**, the WTRU **102** may use default/predetermined information associated with the preamble subsets, the root sequence sets, propagation delay thresholds, on condition that such information is not broadcast in the SI and/or RRC signaled.

(116) At block **615**, the WTRU may read an absolute transmission (TX) time of the SI in the UTC. At block **620**, the WTRU **102** may determine the satellite/NAP **210** position and/or the nadir of the satellite/NAP **210**. At block **625**, the WTRU **102** may determine a current position of the WTRU **102**. At block **630**, the WTRU **102** may determine any of: (1) a relative distance (e.g., from the

WTRU **102** to the satellite/NAP **210** or from the WTRU **102** to the nadir N) associated with the satellite/NAP **210** and/or (2) a relative propagation delay associated with the satellite/NAP **210** based on the absolute TX time. At block **635**, on condition that the WTRU **102** determines a relative delay, the WTRU **102** may determine a differential propagation delay. At block **640**, on condition that the WTRU **102** determines a relative position, the WTRU **102** may determine a distance to the nadir. At block **645**, the WTRU **102** may determine whether to select preamble subsets or root sequence sets. At block **650**, on condition that preamble subsets are selected at block **645**, the WTRU **102** may compare: (1) the determined propagation delay or differential propagation delay to propagation delay thresholds; and/or (2) the determined relative distance to distance thresholds. Based on this comparison, the WTRU **102** may select a preamble subset. The WTRU **102** may randomly select a preamble from the selected preamble subset.

(117) At block **655**, on condition that root sequence sets are selected at block **645**, the WTRU **102** may compare: (1) the determined propagation delay or the determined differential propagation delay to propagation delay thresholds; and/or (2) the determined relative distance to distance thresholds. Based on this comparison, the WTRU **102** may select a root sequence set. The WTRU **102** may: (1) randomly select a preamble from the selected root sequence set; or (2) randomly select a preamble from a defined subset of the preamble sets (the defined subset being selected based on, for example propagation delay related information). At block **660**, the WTRU **102** may initiate a RACH procedure and may enter connected mode. At block **665**, the WTRU **102** may receive RRC signaling. Processing may move to **605** to establish one or more further connections.

(118) Representative Procedure for Physical RACH (PRACH) Masking Based on Relative Distance (e.g., Distance to Nadir)

(119) The gNB **180**/NAP **210** may employ several RACH occasions per duty cycle. For example, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may employ a total of R RACH opportunities, for example every duty cycle (e.g., every 20 ms, evenly or unevenly spread within the 20 ms duty cycle). In certain embodiments, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may restrict access for the WTRUs **102** in a specific geography within the spot beam **510** to one or more RACH opportunities but not all possible R RACH opportunities. More generally, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may configure restrictions access for the WTRUs **102** in a specific geography (e.g., based on the propagation delay (e.g., calculated δ as in Equation 1 or based on distance to the nadir N within the spot beam) to one or more RACH resources within all possible R RACH resources.

(120) For example, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may determine that the WTRUs **102** within a distance of DistTHR.sub.1 from the nadir may use the 1.sup.st RACH opportunity (e.g., only the 1st RACH opportunity) within the duty cycle, The WTRUs **102** within a distance of DistTHR.sub.2 from the nadir and further than DistTHR.sub.1 from the nadir may use the 2.sup.nd RACH opportunity (e.g., only the 2.sup.nd RACH opportunity) within the duty cycle, and so on. In another example, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may determine that WTRUs **102** within a distance of DistTHR.sub.1 from the nadir may use a given RACH resource with a specific frequency domain aspect (e.g., a specific PRB allocation, a specific f_{id} , and/or a specific bandwidth part), and the WTRUs **102** within a distance of DistTHR.sub.2 from the nadir and further than DistTHR.sub.1 from the nadir may use a RACH resource with a different frequency domain aspect, and so on. Similar to the details earlier in the disclosure, the gNB **180**/NAP **210** may employ distance thresholds ψ (e.g., differential or absolute distance thresholds). The WTRU **102A** may have a GNSS receiver allowing the WTRU **102A** to estimate its position (X.sub.A, Y.sub.A) on the coordinate plane where (X, Y) refer to the latitude and longitude of the WTRU **102A**. The nadir of the satellite S/NAP **210** may be estimated by the WTRU **102A** as (X.sub.N, Y.sub.N) using procedures described herein. The distance $\psi_{sub.A} = \sqrt{(X_{sub.A}^2 - X_{sub.N}^2) + (Y_{sub.A}^2 - Y_{sub.N}^2)}$ refers to the distance between the WTRU **102A** and the nadir N of the satellite/NAP **210**.

(121) The gNB **180**/NAP **210** may apply one or more PRACH masks to the duty cycle and may map the masks (e.g., each mask) to distance thresholds (e.g., a distance threshold range) and may

signal the distance threshold ranges via SI, RRC signaling and/or multicasting. The WTRU **102A** may select the RACH opportunity based on a distance $\psi_{\text{sub.A}}$ of the WTRU **102A** with respect to the nadir. An example is set forth in Equation 8, as follows.

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#1 if } d_A < \text{DistTHR}_1 \\
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#2 if } \text{DistTHR}_1 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_2 \\
 (122) \quad \text{WTRURACHOpportunity} = \{ & \text{PRACHMASK\#3 if } \text{DistTHR}_2 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_3 \quad (8) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#R if } \text{DistTHR}_{R-1} \leq d_A
 \end{aligned}$$

(123) Alternately, a RACH opportunity may be as set forth in Equation 9, as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#1 if } d_A < \text{DistTHR}_1 \\
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#2 if } \text{DistTHR}_1 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_2 \\
 (124) \quad \text{WTRURACHOpportunity} = \{ & \text{PRACHMASK\#3 if } \text{DistTHR}_2 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_3 \quad (9) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & \text{PRACHMASK\#R if } \text{DistTHR}_{R-1} \leq d_A
 \end{aligned}$$

Representative Procedure for Decoding RAR Based on Relative Distance (e.g., Distance to the Nadir)

(125) In certain representative embodiments, an RA-RNTI may be made dependent on (e.g., may be based on) a propagation delay related parameter/information, for example a distance from the WTRU **102** to the nadir. The computation of the RA-RNTI formula may consider (e.g., include and/or be a function of) the distance or the differential distance as part of the computation. For example, the RA-RNTI of a cell may be a function of $t_{\text{sub.id}}$ (the index of the sub-frame, where $0 \leq t_{\text{sub.id}} < 10$), $f_{\text{sub.id}}$ (the index of the specified PRACH within that sub-frame, where $0 \leq f_{\text{sub.id}} < 6$), differential propagation delay $\delta_{\text{sub.A}}$, and/or differential distances ($\psi_{\text{sub.A}}$). An example assignment may be:

$$(126) \quad \text{RA - RNTI} = f(t_{\text{id}}, f_{\text{id}}, d_A, \psi_A)$$

where f is any function.

(127) In an example, the RA-RNTI may be formulated (e.g., more generally formulated), as follows in Equation 10 or 11:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{RNTI}_1 \text{ if } d_A < \text{THR}_1 \\
 (128) \quad \text{RA - RNTI} = \{ & \text{RNTI}_2 \text{ if } \text{THR}_1 \leq d_A < \text{THR}_2 \quad (10) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & \text{RNTI}_T \text{ if } \text{THR}_{T-1} \leq d_A
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{RNTI}_1 \text{ if } d_A < \text{DistTHR}_1 \\
 & \text{RNTI}_2 \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_1 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_2 \\
 \text{RA - RNTI} = \{ & \text{RNTI}_3 \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_2 \leq d_A < \text{DistTHR}_3 \quad (11) \\
 & \text{.Math.} \\
 & \text{RNTI}_R \text{ if } \text{DistTHR}_{R-1} \leq d_A
 \end{aligned}$$

(129) The WTRUs **102** may use the appropriate RA-RNTI to decode the RAR. Encoding the distance, as a part of the RA-RNTI, may be useful for the gNB **180**/NAP **210** to address a given WTRU **102** when a preamble collision happens, for example, when the same preamble/preamble set is provided in more than one sub-spot beam **520**, **530** and **540**.

(130) Referring back to FIG. 5, any WTRU **102** in an inner most sub-spot or ring **540** (e.g., a

WTRU **102** at position N or in the vicinity of the nadir) may expect a Physical Downlink Control Channel (PDCCH) of the WTRU **102** at the position N to be scrambled by RNTI.sub.1, and any WTRU **102** in an outermost most sub-spot or ring **520** (e.g., a WTRU **102** at position B or in the vicinity of position B) may expect a PDCCH of the WTRU **102** at position B to be scrambled by RNTI.sub.2, where $RNTI.sub.1 \neq RNTI.sub.2$. The WTRU **102** in the inner most sub-spot/ring **540** may use RNTI.sub.1 to decode its PDCCH and the WTRU **102** in the outermost sub-spot/ring **520** may use RNTI.sub.2 to decode its PDCCH. It is contemplated that this approach does not require different preamble sequences and/or different preamble sets to be used by the WTRUs **102** in different rings. In certain representative embodiments, a set of sequences may be shared by the WTRUs **102** (e.g., all of the WTRUs **102** in a spot beam (e.g., similar to how it is shared by the WTRUs **102** in a terrestrial cell). In other representative embodiments, the set of sequences may be different for various portions of the spot beam **510**. In certain schemes, the WTRUs **102** may be required to determine (e.g., only determine) propagation delays or differential propagation delays $\delta.sub.A$, (as in Equation 1) or distances or differential distances $\psi.sub.A$ to know/determine, which RA-RNTI the WTRU **102** may use and/or may need to use. Such a scheme may decrease time wasted due to collisions, as the PDCCHs may be scrambled by different RNTIs for WTRUs **102** in different rings/annulus, for example to avoid collisions.

(131) Although the areas of the spot beam **510** are divided into sub-spots **520**, **530** and **540**, as different rings, annulus, other divisions are possible such as sectioned rings. For example, the outmost sub-spot **520** may be further divided into any number of sections (e.g., half sections, quarter sections or sixth section, among others). A different RNTI may be used to scramble PDCCHs of WTRUs located in a particular section. The division of the spot beam **510** may be based on the number of WTRUs estimated for the particular division and may be semi-static or dynamically adjusted via broadcast information and/or RRC signaling.

(132) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine whether a RAR (e.g., a MSG2) transmission is applicable based on the content of the RAR. For example, the content of the RAR may include a given distance or a differential distance, where WTRUs **102** falling within such geographical area may be considered applicable. This may be an alternative to changing the RA-RNTI format, while targeting certain WTRUs **102** within a subset of the coverage of the spot beam **510**.

(133) Representative RACH Procedure to Correct Mis-Estimation of Differential Propagation Delay/Distance

(134) If a WTRU **102** miscalculates and/or incorrectly determines the propagation delays/distance (e.g., differential propagation delays/distance) ($\delta.sub.A$, $\psi.sub.A$), an incorrect preamble sequence may be chosen and/or selected. For example, the WTRU **102** may have selected a preamble from a first preamble set (and/or first root sequence) belonging and/or corresponding to a first partition (e.g., a first region **540** of the spot beam **510**, when the WTRU **102** should have selected a second preamble from a second preamble set due to the miscalculation of the propagation delays/distance (e.g., differential propagation delay/distance) (for example, the WTRU **102** being in a different, second partition (e.g., a second region **530** of the spot beam **510**) than the first partition such as a different geographical area that corresponds the second preamble set). Since an RA-RNTI may be dependent on the propagation delays/distance (e.g., differential propagation delay/distance), any of the following may be performed by the WTRU **102**: 1) without waiting for the RAR (that corresponds to the RACH sequence transmitted from the first preamble set) in the RAR window, the WTRU **102** may retransmit MSG1 with a sequence from the correct preamble set (e.g., from the second preamble set); 2) the WTRU **102** may ignore the RAR that may have been received using the RNTI corresponding to the first preamble set, and may not proceed (i) in monitoring the PDCCH for the selected preamble (and/or the RA-RNTI) on which the distance to nadir/propagation delay was miss-estimated, and/or (ii) in sending the MSG3 for that preamble transmission; and/or 3) the WTRU **102** may monitor the RAR corresponding to the sequence

chosen from the second preamble set (e.g., the sequence from the correct preamble set), and may proceed with the MSG3, and MSG4 once the MSG2 is received. (for example, in certain embodiments a two-step RACH may be possible in which MSG1/MSG3 may be sent by the WTRU **102** simultaneously or essentially simultaneously and MSG2/MSG4 may be received by the WTRU **102** simultaneously or essentially simultaneously. The procedure may proceed normally using the preamble selected from the correct preamble set (e.g., the second preamble set), among others. For example, for 2-step RACH, the WTRU **102** may transmit MSG1+MSG3 of second preamble set and may ignore MSG2+MSG4 of first preamble set. The WTRU may, instead, wait for MSG2+MSG4 of second preamble set.

(135) The WTRU **102** may perform any of the above provided a certain period (or timer) has not expired since the instance when the initial preamble was transmitted (e.g., the preamble on which the distance to the nadir and/or propagation delay was miss-estimated).

(136) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive a minimum serviceable elevation angle.

(137) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may estimate a propagation delay to/from satellite with reference to its current position.

(138) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may estimate a position of a satellite S and/or NAP **210** with reference to its current position.

(139) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may estimate the reference propagation delay at the nadir of the satellite S.

(140) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine a difference between the propagation delay from a satellite S to a current position of the satellite and/or the propagation delay from the satellite S to a nadir of the satellite S.

(141) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive, via system information, a number of preamble sets and/or associated propagation delay difference thresholds.

(142) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive, via dedicated RRC signaling, the number of preamble sets and/or associated propagation delay difference thresholds.

(143) In certain representative embodiments, the number of preamble sets and/or associated propagation delay difference thresholds may be different when received via System Information (SI) and via dedicated signaling.

(144) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive the preamble sets and/or the associated propagation delay difference thresholds applicable for use in any of: (1) idle mode (e.g., only when in Idle mode); (2) in Connected mode; or (3) both.

(145) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may apply a default preamble set and/or an associated propagation delay difference mapping configuration, if a preamble set and/or an associated propagation delay difference mapping configuration is not received via SI and/or via dedicated signaling.

(146) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be configured in the ME and/or the USIM to determine whether to apply a default preamble set and/or an associated propagation delay difference map.

(147) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be signaled via SI whether to apply a default preamble set and/or a default associated propagation delay difference map.

(148) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may configure one or more procedures in the ME and/or in the USIM to execute a scheme to determine the default preamble sets and/or the associated propagation delay difference map.

(149) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive a parameter (e.g., a PREAMBLESET_INDICATOR parameter) via SI and/or via dedicated signaling to determine the preconfigured procedure to execute for determining the default preamble sets and/or the associated propagation delay difference map.

(150) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select a preamble subset, for

example by comparing an estimated propagation delay difference to propagation delay thresholds signaled by the gNB **180/NAP 210**.

(151) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select the preamble subset, for example by comparing an estimated propagation delay difference to propagation delay thresholds provided by default from the ME/USIM.

(152) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive, via SI, a RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference thresholds.

(153) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive, via dedicated RRC signaling, a RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference thresholds.

(154) In certain representative embodiments, the RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and the associated propagation delay difference thresholds may be different when received via SI and via dedicated signaling.

(155) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive a RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference thresholds applicable for use only when in Idle mode, only when in Connected mode or both.

(156) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may apply a default RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference mapping configuration, if not received via SI.

(157) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be configured, for example using the ME and/or the USIM to determine whether to apply a default RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference map. In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be signaled, via SI, whether to apply a default RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices and/or the associated propagation delay difference map.

(158) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be configured with one or more procedures using or in the ME or the USIM to execute a scheme to determine the RACH root sequence set and/or the associated propagation delay difference map.

(159) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may be configured with one or more procedures to generate the default RACH root sequence set consisting of or including one or more root sequence indices.

(160) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select the RACH root sequence index from the RACH root sequence set, for example by comparing an estimated propagation delay difference to the propagation delay thresholds signaled by gNB. In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select the RACH root sequence index from the RACH root sequence set, for example by comparing the estimated propagation delay difference to the propagation delay thresholds defaulted from the ME/USIM.

(161) Representative RACH Procedure for Aerial WTRUs

(162) The aforementioned embodiments naturally extend to the case of Aerial Vehicles (e.g., Unmanned Aerial Vehicles/Drones). In the more general case, the Nadir N, need not be on the surface of the earth (as discussed previously), but can be at an arbitrary altitude, where the latter is signaled by the gNB **180/NAP 210** and/or may be preconfigured in the USIM. For example, one or more signaled altitudes may represent a maximum height at which a drone can operate and/or a height that the drone is currently operating in the system. Based on the one or more signaled altitudes, the parameter D.sub.min can be calculated once the position of the satellite S is known as described earlier. In certain representative embodiments, the gNB **180/NAP 210** may signal D.sub.min through one or more SI messages and/or via other means so that any WTRU **102** (aerial/terrestrial) may implement Equation (1) to calculate δ . The rest of the procedure for

preamble selection follows similar techniques described previously as in Equation 4, or Equation 5.

(163) FIG. 7 is flowchart illustrating a representative procedure to perform RACH.

(164) Referring to FIG. 7, a representative procedure **700** may include, at block **710**, the WTRU **102** receiving preamble sets or root sequences associated with differential propagation delay thresholds. At block **720**, the WTRU **102** may determine propagation delay between the WTRU **102** and the NAP **210**. At block **730**, the WTRU **102** may compare the determine propagation delay with differential propagation delay thresholds. At block **740**, the WTRU **102** may select an appropriate preamble set or root sequence. At block **750**, the WTRU **102** may perform a RACH procedure.

(165) FIG. 8 is flowchart illustrating another representative procedure for selection of RACH preambles based on propagation delay related parameters/information.

(166) Referring to FIG. 8, a representative procedure **800** may include, at block **810**, the WTRU **102** receiving from a NAP **210**, a set of preambles and corresponding propagation delay related thresholds. At block **820**, the WTRU **102** may determine propagation delay related information associated with a distance between the WTRU and the NAP or a location in a coverage of the NAP **210**. At block **830**, the WTRU **102** may select a subset of preambles from the set of preambles based on the determined propagation delay related information. At block **840**, the WTRU **102** may randomly select a preamble from the selected subset of preambles. At block **850**, the WTRU **102** may send the randomly selected preamble to the NAP.

(167) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may choose a root sequence, wherein the selecting of the subset of preambles includes selecting the subset of preambles in accordance with the chosen root sequence.

(168) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive from the NAP, network access information; and may initiate network access using the network access information.

(169) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine a Random Access Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) that is a function of, derived from or includes at least the propagation delay related information and may decode the network access information included in a Random Access Response (RAR) using the determined RA-RNTI.

(170) In certain representative embodiments, the NAP **210** may be included in a satellite and/or may be part of a non-terrestrial network.

(171) In certain representative embodiments, the propagation delay related information may include any of: (1) a distance from the WTRU **102** to the NAP **210**; (2) a distance from the WTRU **102** to a nadir N of the NAP **210**; (3) an angle between a line extending between the WTRU **102** and the NAP **210** and a line extending between the nadir N of the NAP **210** and the NAP **210**; or (4) the propagation delay or a differential propagation delay of a signal sent between the WTRU **102** and the NAP **210**.

(172) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive via broadcast information or dedicated signaling, a Random Access configuration including the set of propagation delay related thresholds and any of: (1) location information indicating a location of the NAP **210**; or (2) path information indicating a path to be traversed by the NAP **210**.

(173) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select one orthogonal subset of the set of preambles that corresponds to a particular portion of the coverage of the NAP **210**.

(174) In certain representative embodiments, each portion of the coverage of the NAP **210** may correspond to a respectively different subset of the set of preambles.

(175) In certain representative embodiments, each orthogonal subset of the set of preambles may be any of: (1) preconfigured with corresponding propagation delay related thresholds; or (2) signaled explicitly by the NAP **210**.

(176) In certain representative embodiments, the selected subset of the set of preambles may correspond to an annular or oval ring shaped region or a portion of the annular or the oval ring shaped region of a coverage area. It is contemplated that the coverage of the NAP is a coverage

volume which may correspond with the terrestrial surface (e.g., Earth's surface) to generally define a coverage area.

(177) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine a subregion of the coverage area of the NAP **210** and may select the subset of preambles associated with the subregion of the coverage area by, for example any of: (1) comparing a determined value of the propagation delay related information to one or more propagation delay related thresholds; or (2) via a lookup table associated with the determined value of the propagation delay related information.

(178) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive from the NAP **210** via system information any of: (1) GNSS coordinates periodically or (2) a serviceable elevation angle of the NAP **210**.

(179) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may receive from the NAP **210**, restriction information and in accordance with the restriction information may restrict any of: (1) one or more RACH occasions to send the randomly selected preamble to the NAP **210**; or (2) a number of cyclic shifts associated of a RACH root sequence used by the WTRU **102**.

(180) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may restrict the randomly selected preamble to a first RACH occasion or a first set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU **102** is in any of: (1) a first coverage area of the NAP **210**; (2) a first range of distances to a nadir N of the NAP **210**; (3) a first range of distances to the NAP **210**, or (4) a first range of propagation delays to the NAP **210**.

(181) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may restrict the randomly selected preamble to a second RACH occasion or a second set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU **102** is in any of: (1) a second coverage area of the NAP **210**; (2) a second range of distances to a nadir N of the NAP **210**; (3) a second range of distances to the NAP **210**, or (4) a second range of propagation delays to the NAP **210**.

(182) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine an altitude of the WTRU such that the propagation delay related information may be further based on the determined altitude.

(183) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine an altitude of the WTRU **102** and may determine the propagation delay related information as function of the determined altitude, on condition that the determined altitude exceeds a threshold value.

(184) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may determine a type of WTRU **102** and may determine the propagation delay related information based on an altitude of the WTRU **102** on condition that the determined type is a first type of WTRU **102**. For example, the first type of WTRU **102** may be an aerial drone and/or an aerial device.

(185) In certain representative embodiments, each preamble of the selected subset of preambles may be: (1) a cyclically shifted version of a CAZAC root sequence.

(186) In certain representative embodiments, the selected preamble may be a random access preamble (RAP) sent in a RAP message and the received network access information may be received in a random access response (RAR) message that is in response to the RAP message.

(187) In certain representative embodiments, the network access information may include a timing advance for the WTRU **102** and/or a power command for the WTRU **102**.

(188) FIG. **9** is flowchart illustrating another representative procedure using a Random Access-Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) as a function of, including or derived from propagation delay related parameter/information.

(189) Referring to FIG. **9**, a representative procedure **900** may include, at block **910**, the WTRU **102** determining propagation delay related information associated with a distance between the WTRU **102** and a NAP **210** or a location in a coverage of the NAP **210**. At block **920**, the WTRU **102** may receive a Random Access Response (RAR) masked with a Random Access-Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) that is a function of, derived from or includes at least

the determined propagation delay related information. At block **930**, the WTRU **102** may determine the RA-RNTI based on the determined propagation delay related information. At block **940**, the WTRU **102** may decode the RAR using the determined RA-RNTI.

(190) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may send to a network entity (e.g., NAP **210**), a message with a timing advance and a power level derived based on information indicated by the RAR.

(191) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may send to a network entity **210**, a Random Access Preamble (RAP) that may indicate the RA-RNTI associated with the WTRU **102**.

(192) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may select a subset of RAPs from the set of RAPs based on the determined propagation delay related information and may randomly select the RAP from the selected subset of RAPs.

(193) In certain representative embodiments, the RAR may be masked with or scrambled with the RA-RNTI and the RA-RNTI may be a function of a propagation delay or a differential propagation delay and any of: (1) a subframe index; or (2) a Physical Random Access Channel (PRACH) resource index.

(194) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may compare the RA-RNTI associated with the received RAR with the RA-RNTI determined based on the determined propagation delay related information, as a RA-RNTI comparison result and may determine whether the received RAR is intended for the WTRU **102** using the RA-RNTI comparison result.

(195) In certain representative embodiments, the WTRU **102** may decode the received RAR on condition that on the RAR is intended for the WTRU **102** in accordance with the RA-RNTI comparison result.

(196) In certain representative embodiments, the propagation delay related information includes any of: (1) a distance from the WTRU **102** to the NAP **210**; (2) a distance from the WTRU **102** to a nadir N of the NAP **210**; (3) an angle between a line extending between the WTRU **102** and the NAP **210** and a line extending between the nadir N of the NAP **210** and the NAP **210**; or (4) the propagation delay of a signal sent between the WTRU **102** and the NAP **210**.

(197) The terms “differential propagation delay” and “propagation delay differences” may be used interchangeably herein and generally refer to the propagation delay associated with a WTRU in a spot beam that may exceed a minimum propagation delay (e.g., associated with the nadir N of the spotbeam) or a pre-established or signaled propagation delay (e.g., associated with a border of a sub-spot beam).

(198) Although the disclosure illustrates the use of propagation delay differences for preamble and root sequence selection, one of skill understands that any propagation delay related information/parameter may be used for such a selection.

(199) Although the disclosure illustrates the use of propagation delay differences for RA-RNTI derivation, one of skill understands that any propagation delay related information/parameter may be used for such a derivation.

(200) Systems and methods for processing data according to representative embodiments may be performed by one or more processors executing sequences of instructions contained in a memory device. Such instructions may be read into the memory device from other computer-readable mediums such as secondary data storage device(s). Execution of the sequences of instructions contained in the memory device causes the processor to operate, for example, as described above. In alternative embodiments, hard-wire circuitry may be used in place of or in combination with software instructions to implement the present invention. Such software may run on a processor which is housed within a robotic assistance/apparatus (RAA) and/or another mobile device remotely. In the later a case, data may be transferred via wireline or wirelessly between the RAA or other mobile device containing the sensors and the remote device containing the processor which runs the software which performs the scale estimation and compensation as described above. According to other representative embodiments, some of the processing described above with

respect to localization may be performed in the device containing the sensors/cameras, while the remainder of the processing may be performed in a second device after receipt of the partially processed data from the device containing the sensors/cameras.

(201) Although features and elements are described above in particular combinations, one of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that each feature or element can be used alone or in any combination with the other features and elements. In addition, the methods described herein may be implemented in a computer program, software, or firmware incorporated in a computer readable medium for execution by a computer or processor. Examples of non-transitory computer-readable storage media include, but are not limited to, a read only memory (ROM), random access memory (RAM), a register, cache memory, semiconductor memory devices, magnetic media such as internal hard disks and removable disks, magneto-optical media, and optical media such as CD-ROM disks, and digital versatile disks (DVDs). A processor in association with software may be used to implement a radio frequency transceiver for use in a WTRU, UE, terminal, base station, RNC, or any host computer.

(202) Moreover, in the embodiments described above, processing platforms, computing systems, controllers, and other devices containing processors are noted. These devices may contain at least one Central Processing Unit (“CPU”) and memory. In accordance with the practices of persons skilled in the art of computer programming, reference to acts and symbolic representations of operations or instructions may be performed by the various CPUs and memories. Such acts and operations or instructions may be referred to as being “executed,” “computer executed” or “CPU executed.”

(203) One of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the acts and symbolically represented operations or instructions include the manipulation of electrical signals by the CPU. An electrical system represents data bits that can cause a resulting transformation or reduction of the electrical signals and the maintenance of data bits at memory locations in a memory system to thereby reconfigure or otherwise alter the CPU's operation, as well as other processing of signals. The memory locations where data bits are maintained are physical locations that have particular electrical, magnetic, optical, or organic properties corresponding to or representative of the data bits. It should be understood that the representative embodiments are not limited to the above-mentioned platforms or CPUs and that other platforms and CPUs may support the provided methods.

(204) The data bits may also be maintained on a computer readable medium including magnetic disks, optical disks, and any other volatile (e.g., Random Access Memory (“RAM”)) or non-volatile (e.g., Read-Only Memory (“ROM”)) mass storage system readable by the CPU. The computer readable medium may include cooperating or interconnected computer readable medium, which exist exclusively on the processing system or are distributed among multiple interconnected processing systems that may be local or remote to the processing system. It is understood that the representative embodiments are not limited to the above-mentioned memories and that other platforms and memories may support the described methods. It should be understood that the representative embodiments are not limited to the above-mentioned platforms or CPUs and that other platforms and CPUs may support the provided methods.

(205) In an illustrative embodiment, any of the operations, processes, etc. described herein may be implemented as computer-readable instructions stored on a computer-readable medium. The computer-readable instructions may be executed by a processor of a mobile unit, a network element, and/or any other computing device.

(206) There is little distinction left between hardware and software implementations of aspects of systems. The use of hardware or software is generally (but not always, in that in certain contexts the choice between hardware and software may become significant) a design choice representing cost vs. efficiency tradeoffs. There may be various vehicles by which processes and/or systems and/or other technologies described herein may be affected (e.g., hardware, software, and/or

firmware), and the preferred vehicle may vary with the context in which the processes and/or systems and/or other technologies are deployed. For example, if an implementer determines that speed and accuracy are paramount, the implementer may opt for a mainly hardware and/or firmware vehicle. If flexibility is paramount, the implementer may opt for a mainly software implementation. Alternatively, the implementer may opt for some combination of hardware, software, and/or firmware.

(207) The foregoing detailed description has set forth various embodiments of the devices and/or processes via the use of block diagrams, flowcharts, and/or examples. Insofar as such block diagrams, flowcharts, and/or examples contain one or more functions and/or operations, it will be understood by those within the art that each function and/or operation within such block diagrams, flowcharts, or examples may be implemented, individually and/or collectively, by a wide range of hardware, software, firmware, or virtually any combination thereof. Suitable processors include, by way of example, a general purpose processor, a special purpose processor, a conventional processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in association with a DSP core, a controller, a microcontroller, Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), Application Specific Standard Products (ASSPs); Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs) circuits, any other type of integrated circuit (IC), and/or a state machine.

(208) Although features and elements are provided above in particular combinations, one of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that each feature or element can be used alone or in any combination with the other features and elements. The present disclosure is not to be limited in terms of the particular embodiments described in this application, which are intended as illustrations of various aspects. Many modifications and variations may be made without departing from its spirit and scope, as will be apparent to those skilled in the art. No element, act, or instruction used in the description of the present application should be construed as critical or essential to the invention unless explicitly provided as such. Functionally equivalent methods and apparatuses within the scope of the disclosure, in addition to those enumerated herein, will be apparent to those skilled in the art from the foregoing descriptions. Such modifications and variations are intended to fall within the scope of the appended claims. The present disclosure is to be limited only by the terms of the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled. It is to be understood that this disclosure is not limited to particular methods or systems.

(209) It is also to be understood that the terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only, and is not intended to be limiting. As used herein, when referred to herein, the terms “station” and its abbreviation “STA”, “user equipment” and its abbreviation “UE” may mean (i) a wireless transmit and/or receive unit (WTRU), such as described infra; (ii) any of a number of embodiments of a WTRU, such as described infra; (iii) a wireless-capable and/or wired-capable (e.g., tetherable) device configured with, inter alia, some or all structures and functionality of a WTRU, such as described infra; (iii) a wireless-capable and/or wired-capable device configured with less than all structures and functionality of a WTRU, such as described infra; or (iv) the like. Details of an example WTRU, which may be representative of any UE recited herein, are provided, for example, with respect to FIGS. 1A-1D.

(210) In certain representative embodiments, several portions of the subject matter described herein may be implemented via Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), digital signal processors (DSPs), and/or other integrated formats. However, those skilled in the art will recognize that some aspects of the embodiments disclosed herein, in whole or in part, may be equivalently implemented in integrated circuits, as one or more computer programs running on one or more computers (e.g., as one or more programs running on one or more computer systems), as one or more programs running on one or more processors (e.g., as one or more programs running on one or more microprocessors), as firmware, or as virtually any

combination thereof, and that designing the circuitry and/or writing the code for the software and or firmware would be well within the skill of one of skill in the art in light of this disclosure. In addition, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the mechanisms of the subject matter described herein may be distributed as a program product in a variety of forms, and that an illustrative embodiment of the subject matter described herein applies regardless of the particular type of signal bearing medium used to actually carry out the distribution. Examples of a signal bearing medium include, but are not limited to, the following: a recordable type medium such as a floppy disk, a hard disk drive, a CD, a DVD, a digital tape, a computer memory, etc., and a transmission type medium such as a digital and/or an analog communication medium (e.g., a fiber optic cable, a waveguide, a wired communications link, a wireless communication link, etc.).

(211) The herein described subject matter sometimes illustrates different components contained within, or connected with, different other components. It is to be understood that such depicted architectures are merely examples, and that in fact many other architectures may be implemented which achieve the same functionality. In a conceptual sense, any arrangement of components to achieve the same functionality is effectively “associated” such that the desired functionality may be achieved. Hence, any two components herein combined to achieve a particular functionality may be seen as “associated with” each other such that the desired functionality is achieved, irrespective of architectures or intermediate components. Likewise, any two components so associated may also be viewed as being “operably connected”, or “operably coupled”, to each other to achieve the desired functionality, and any two components capable of being so associated may also be viewed as being “operably couplable” to each other to achieve the desired functionality. Specific examples of operably couplable include but are not limited to physically mateable and/or physically interacting components and/or wirelessly interactable and/or wirelessly interacting components and/or logically interacting and/or logically interactable components.

(212) With respect to the use of substantially any plural and/or singular terms herein, those having skill in the art can translate from the plural to the singular and/or from the singular to the plural as is appropriate to the context and/or application. The various singular/plural permutations may be expressly set forth herein for sake of clarity.

(213) It will be understood by those within the art that, in general, terms used herein, and especially in the appended claims (e.g., bodies of the appended claims) are generally intended as “open” terms (e.g., the term “including” should be interpreted as “including but not limited to,” the term “having” should be interpreted as “having at least,” the term “includes” should be interpreted as “includes but is not limited to,” etc.). It will be further understood by those within the art that if a specific number of an introduced claim recitation is intended, such an intent will be explicitly recited in the claim, and in the absence of such recitation no such intent is present. For example, where only one item is intended, the term “single” or similar language may be used. As an aid to understanding, the following appended claims and/or the descriptions herein may contain usage of the introductory phrases “at least one” and “one or more” to introduce claim recitations. However, the use of such phrases should not be construed to imply that the introduction of a claim recitation by the indefinite articles “a” or “an” limits any particular claim containing such introduced claim recitation to embodiments containing only one such recitation, even when the same claim includes the introductory phrases “one or more” or “at least one” and indefinite articles such as “a” or “an” (e.g., “a” and/or “an” should be interpreted to mean “at least one” or “one or more”). The same holds true for the use of definite articles used to introduce claim recitations. In addition, even if a specific number of an introduced claim recitation is explicitly recited, those skilled in the art will recognize that such recitation should be interpreted to mean at least the recited number (e.g., the bare recitation of “two recitations,” without other modifiers, means at least two recitations, or two or more recitations). Furthermore, in those instances where a convention analogous to “at least one of A, B, and C, etc.” is used, in general such a construction is intended in the sense one having skill in the art would understand the convention (e.g., “a system having at least one of A, B, and C”

would include but not be limited to systems that have A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B together, A and C together, B and C together, and/or A, B, and C together, etc.). In those instances where a convention analogous to “at least one of A, B, or C, etc.” is used, in general such a construction is intended in the sense one having skill in the art would understand the convention (e.g., “a system having at least one of A, B, or C” would include but not be limited to systems that have A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B together, A and C together, B and C together, and/or A, B, and C together, etc.). It will be further understood by those within the art that virtually any disjunctive word and/or phrase presenting two or more alternative terms, whether in the description, claims, or drawings, should be understood to contemplate the possibilities of including one of the terms, either of the terms, or both terms. For example, the phrase “A or B” will be understood to include the possibilities of “A” or “B” or “A and B.” Further, the terms “any of” followed by a listing of a plurality of items and/or a plurality of categories of items, as used herein, are intended to include “any of,” “any combination of,” “any multiple of,” and/or “any combination of multiples of” the items and/or the categories of items, individually or in conjunction with other items and/or other categories of items. Moreover, as used herein, the term “set” or “group” is intended to include any number of items, including zero. Additionally, as used herein, the term “number” is intended to include any number, including zero.

(214) In addition, where features or aspects of the disclosure are described in terms of Markush groups, those skilled in the art will recognize that the disclosure is also thereby described in terms of any individual member or subgroup of members of the Markush group.

(215) As will be understood by one skilled in the art, for any and all purposes, such as in terms of providing a written description, all ranges disclosed herein also encompass any and all possible subranges and combinations of subranges thereof. Any listed range can be easily recognized as sufficiently describing and enabling the same range being broken down into at least equal halves, thirds, quarters, fifths, tenths, etc. As a non-limiting example, each range discussed herein may be readily broken down into a lower third, middle third and upper third, etc. As will also be understood by one skilled in the art all language such as “up to,” “at least,” “greater than,” “less than,” and the like includes the number recited and refers to ranges which can be subsequently broken down into subranges as discussed above. Finally, as will be understood by one skilled in the art, a range includes each individual member. Thus, for example, a group having 1-3 cells refers to groups having 1, 2, or 3 cells. Similarly, a group having 1-5 cells refers to groups having 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5 cells, and so forth.

(216) Moreover, the claims should not be read as limited to the provided order or elements unless stated to that effect. In addition, use of the terms “means for” in any claim is intended to invoke 35 U.S.C. § 112, ¶ 6 or means-plus-function claim format, and any claim without the terms “means for” is not so intended.

(217) A processor in association with software may be used to implement a radio frequency transceiver for use in a wireless transmit receive unit (WTRU), user equipment (UE), terminal, base station, Mobility Management Entity (MME) or Evolved Packet Core (EPC), or any host computer. The WTRU may be used in conjunction with modules, implemented in hardware and/or software including a Software Defined Radio (SDR), and other components such as a camera, a video camera module, a videophone, a speakerphone, a vibration device, a speaker, a microphone, a television transceiver, a hands free headset, a keyboard, a Bluetooth® module, a frequency modulated (FM) radio unit, a Near Field Communication (NFC) Module, a liquid crystal display (LCD) display unit, an organic light-emitting diode (OLED) display unit, a digital music player, a media player, a video game player module, an Internet browser, and/or any Wireless Local Area Network (WLAN) or Ultra Wide Band (UWB) module.

(218) Throughout the disclosure, one of skill understands that certain representative embodiments may be used in the alternative or in combination with other representative embodiments.

Claims

1. A method implemented by a wireless transmit/receive unit (WTRU), the method comprising: determining propagation-delay-related information associated with any of: a distance between the WTRU and a network access point (NAP), and a distance between the WTRU and a location in a coverage area of the NAP; determining a preamble from a set of preambles based on the determined propagation-delay-related information; sending the preamble to the NAP; receiving, from the NAP, network access information; determining a Random Access Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) that is a function of, derived from, or includes, at least the determined propagation-delay-related information; and decoding the network access information using the determined RA-RNTI.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the determining of the preamble includes selecting a root sequence using the determined propagation-delay related information.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: initiating, by the WTRU, network access using the network access information.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the NAP is included in a satellite and is a part of a non-terrestrial network, the method further comprising: receiving, by the WTRU from the NAP, via system information, any of: (1) global navigation satellite system (GNSS) coordinates periodically or (2) a serviceable elevation angle of the NAP; and determining an altitude of the WTRU, wherein the determining of the propagation-delay-related information is further based on the determined altitude and the received system information.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the propagation-delay-related information includes any of: (1) a distance from the WTRU to the NAP; (2) a distance from the WTRU to a nadir of the NAP; (3) an angle between a line extending between the WTRU and the NAP and a line extending between the nadir of the NAP and the NAP; or (4) the propagation delay or a differential propagation delay of a signal sent between the WTRU and the NAP.
6. The method of claim 1, comprising receiving, by the WTRU, via broadcast information or dedicated signaling, Random Access configuration information indicating a set of propagation-delay-related thresholds and any of: (1) location information indicating a location of the NAP; or (2) path information indicating a path to be traversed by the NAP.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the determining of the preamble from a set of preambles includes: determining a subregion of the coverage area of the NAP; and determining a preamble associated with the subregion of the coverage area of the NAP by any of: (1) comparing a determined value of the propagation-delay-related information to one or more propagation-delay-related thresholds; or (2) via a lookup table associated with the determined value of the propagation-delay-related information.
8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, by the WTRU from the NAP, restriction information; and restricting in accordance with the restriction information any of: (1) one or more Random Access Channel (RACH) occasions to send the randomly selected preamble to the NAP; or (2) a number of cyclic shifts associated with a RACH root sequence used by the WTRU.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein: the sending of the preamble is restricted to a first Random Access Channel (RACH) occasion or a first set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU is in any of: (1) a first coverage area of the NAP; (2) a first range of distances to a nadir of the NAP; (3) a first range of distances to the NAP, or (4) a first range of propagation delays to the NAP; and the sending of the preamble is restricted to a second RACH occasion or a second set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU is in any of: (1) a second coverage area of the NAP; (2) a second range of distances to a nadir of the NAP; (3) a second range of distances to the NAP, or (4) a second range of propagation delays to the NAP.
10. A wireless transmit/receive unit (WTRU), comprising: circuitry, including any of a processor

and a transceiver, configured to: determine propagation-delay-related information associated with any of: a distance between the WTRU and a network access point (NAP), and a distance between the WTRU and a location in a coverage area of the NAP; determine a preamble from a set of preambles based on the determined propagation-delay-related information; send the preamble to the NAP; receive, from the NAP, network access information; determine a Random Access Radio Network Temporary Identifier (RA-RNTI) that is a function of, derived from, or includes, at least the determined propagation-delay-related information; and decode the network access information using the determined RA-RNTI.

11. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein, to determine the preamble, the at least one processor is configured to select a root sequence using the determined propagation-delay related information.

12. The WTRU of claim 10, configured to: initiate network access using the network access information.

13. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein the NAP is included in a satellite and is a part of a non-terrestrial network, wherein the transceiver is configured to receive, from the NAP, via system information, any of: (1) global navigation satellite system (GNSS) coordinates periodically or (2) a serviceable elevation angle of the NAP, wherein the at least one processor is configured to determine an altitude of the WTRU, and wherein the determining of the propagation-delay-related information is further based on the determined altitude and the received system information.

14. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein the propagation-delay-related information includes any of: (1) a distance from the WTRU to the NAP; (2) a distance from the WTRU to a nadir of the NAP; (3) an angle between a line extending between the WTRU and the NAP and a line extending between the nadir of the NAP and the NAP; or (4) the propagation delay or a differential propagation delay of a signal sent between the WTRU and the NAP.

15. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein the transceiver is configured to receive, via broadcast information or dedicated signaling, Random Access configuration information indicating a set of propagation-delay-related thresholds and any of: (1) location information indicating a location of the NAP; or (2) path information indicating a path to be traversed by the NAP.

16. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein, to determine the preamble from the set of preambles, the at least one processor is configured to: determine a subregion of the coverage area of the NAP; and determine a preamble associated with the subregion of the coverage area of the NAP by any of: (1) comparing a determined value of the propagation-delay-related information to one or more propagation-delay-related thresholds; or (2) via a lookup table associated with the determined value of the propagation-delay-related information.

17. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein: the transceiver is configured to receive, from the NAP, restriction information; and the at least one processor is configured to restrict in accordance with the restriction information any of: (1) one or more Random Access Channel (RACH) occasions to send the randomly selected preamble to the NAP; or (2) a number of cyclic shifts associated with a RACH root sequence used by the WTRU.

18. The WTRU of claim 10, wherein: the sending of the preamble is restricted to a first Random Access Channel (RACH) occasion or a first set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU is in any of: (1) a first coverage area of the NAP; (2) a first range of distances to a nadir of the NAP; (3) a first range of distances to the NAP, or (4) a first range of propagation delays to the NAP; and the sending of the preamble is restricted to a second RACH occasion or a second set of RACH occasions, on condition that the WTRU is in any of: (1) a second coverage area of the NAP; (2) a second range of distances to a nadir of the NAP; (3) a second range of distances to the NAP, or (4) a second range of propagation delays to the NAP.

19. A wireless transmit/receive unit (WTRU), comprising: circuitry, including any of a processor, transmitter, receiver, and memory, the circuitry configured to determine propagation-delay-related information associated with any of: (1) a distance between the WTRU and a network access point (NAP) and (2) a distance between the WTRU and a location in a coverage area of the NAP; receive

a random access response (RAR) masked with a random access radio network temporary identifier (RA-RNTI), wherein the random access radio network temporary identifier (RA-RNTI) is a function of, derived from, or includes, a propagation delay or a differential propagation delay and any of: (1) a subframe index and (2) a Physical Random Access Channel (PRACH) resource index; determine the random access radio network temporary identifier (RA-RNTI) based on the propagation-delay-related information; and decode the random access response (RAR) using the determined random access radio network temporary identifier (RA-RNTI).
